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Jude

Jude 1:1

Section 1–2: Jude greeted his readers

In New Testament times the common way to begin a letter was to put the writer's name first, then to mention something about the people who would receive the letter. After that, the writer included a prayer or blessing for their well-being. Jude followed this pattern.

Although Jude did not say where his readers lived, he did say three things about them. These three things are true of all believers:

1. God had called them,
2. God the Father loved them,
3. God would keep them safe for the time when Jesus Christ would return.

In these two verses Jude identified himself as the author of the letter and identified his readers by some of the things that God had done for them. Then he prayed that God would bless them. Jude chose a blessing which related well to the rest of the letter.

1a Jude,

- ¶ I Jude writes this letter to you^(plur).
- ¶ I, Jude, write this letter to you^(plur).
- ¶ This letter comes from me, Jude.

Jude: The BSB, like the Greek text, begins with the name of the writer and does not follow it with a verb. This was the common way to start a letter in New Testament times. In many languages today, including English, the writer's name does not appear until the end of the letter. However, even if this is also true in your language, you should still include Jude's name in this first verse. You may need to add a verb. For example:

Jude writes this letter to you.

In some languages, like Greek, it is acceptable for a writer to identify himself in the third person, as Jude did here. If this is not natural in your language, you could add a first person pronoun. For example,

It is I, Jude, who write this letter to you.

1b a servant of Jesus Christ

- I am a servant of Jesus Christ,
- I work for Jesus Christ,

a servant of Jesus Christ: Even though Jude was the brother of Jesus, he described himself as a servant of Jesus Christ. His brother James wrote the same thing about himself (James 1:1). This was a common way for followers of Jesus to describe themselves. It is often found at the beginning of the letters in the New Testament. (Philippians 1:1; Titus 1:1; James 1:1; 2 Peter 1:1.)

servant: The Greek word that the BSB translates as servant is *doulos*. This word may also be translated as “slave.” If your language does not have a noun for servant, you may use a verb instead. For example:

I serve Jesus Christ.

who works for Jesus Christ.

Christ: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as Christ may be translated as part of the name, Jesus Christ. See Christ in the Glossary.

1c and a brother of James,

- and I am a brother of James.
- and James is my brother.

and a brother of James: We do not know which of the brothers was older, James. In these Notes, James refers to an important leader of the church at Jerusalem (Acts 12:17), the James who was the brother of Jesus (as Paul says in Galatians 2:19). Jude was another brother of Jesus. or Jude. If your language requires that you say which brother was older, you may say that Jude is the younger brother of James. It is likely that James was older, because he was an important leader of the Christians in Jerusalem.

brother: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as brother can be used for different relationships. In some languages it is necessary to use a different expression for each of these relationships. James and Jude had the same mother and father.

James: This James was a leader of the church at Jerusalem (Acts 12:17). He was also the brother. Some Christians believe that Jude and James were children born to both Joseph and Mary. Jesus would then be their older half-brother, since Joseph was not Jesus' biological father. Others believe that Jude and James were the children of Joseph by a wife who had died before he married Mary. This would make Jesus their younger stepbrother. Still others believe that the

“brother” relationship was by adoption or as part of an extended family. Those who believe in the perpetual virginity of Mary do not believe that Jude and James were born to Mary. of Jesus (as Paul says in Galatians 1:19). Jude was another brother of Jesus. In some languages it may be helpful to include this information in a footnote in your translation.

1d

To those who are called,

- I write to those people who have been called by God to believe in him.
- I write to you^(plur) people whom God has invited/asked to believe in him.

To those who are called: Here Jude began to say something about the people to whom he was writing. In some languages it may be necessary to introduce this clause by a phrase like:

I write to you, those who....

called: Jude used the Greek word that the BSB translates as called to refer to the Christian people to whom he was writing. He described them as called, because God had called them to believe in him. This can be translated as:

To those people who have been called by God to believe in him

To you people whom God has called to believe in him.

See the general comment at the end of the notes for 1f for other suggestions on using active verbs to translate the ideas in this verse.

1e

loved by God the Father,

- You^(plur) are united/joined with God the Father because you^(plur) have been loved by him.
- God the Father loves you^(plur) with the result that you^(plur) are united/joined with him,

loved by God the Father: A literal translation of the Greek text here is “having been loved in (en) God the Father.” This phrase includes two ideas:

1. God the Father loved these Christians.
2. These Christians experienced God’s love in their relationship to him, united with him. John 17 has other examples where “in” has this meaning. Jude expressed the same idea again in 21a where he

encouraged his readers “to keep yourselves in the love of God.”

If possible, it is best to include both ideas in your translation. For example:

who live in the love of God the Father (GNT)

You are united with God the Father because you have been loved by him.

God the Father loves you with the result that you are united with him.

loved: Copies of the Greek text are slightly different from each other. The KJV has “sanctified” instead of “loved,” because it followed different copies than most other English versions followed. The best evidence supports “loved,” so it is recommended that you use the idea “loved” in your translation. However, if the major language version in your area uses “sanctified,” you may include a footnote to say that “sanctified” can be found in some Greek copies, but that the best evidence supports “loved.” God had much affection for these Christians and great concern for their well-being. See Love, Meaning 1, in the Glossary.

1f

and kept in Jesus Christ:

- He/God has kept you^(plur) safe for Jesus Christ.
- and he keeps you^(plur) safe to give/present you^(plur) to Jesus Christ when he returns.

kept in Jesus Christ: In this context there are two ways to interpret the Greek expression. Differences in interpretation arise, in part, because the Greek text has no preposition. In English, a preposition is required. that the BSB translates as kept in Jesus Christ:

1. It means kept for Jesus Christ. For example:

kept safe for Jesus Christ (NJB) (GW, NASB, NET, NJB, NRSV, REB, RSV)

1. It means kept by Jesus Christ. For example:

kept safe by Jesus Christ (CEV) (CEV, JBP, NIV, GNT)

It is recommended that you follow interpretation (1). Similar ideas are expressed in John chapter 17, especially in John 17:9 and John 17:15. It is likely that Jude meant that God was the one who was keeping the readers for Jesus Christ. Jude may be implying “for

Jesus Christ when he returns.” Here is an example of how to make this explicit:

are kept safe for the coming of Jesus Christ.(REB)

Jude may also imply:

who are kept safe by God to give/present to Jesus Christ at his return.

kept: Jude frequently used the Greek verb, *tēreō*, which the BSB translates here as kept. He used a form of *tēreō* in 1f, 6a, 6c, 13d (where the BSB uses the verb “reserved”), and 21a. Though it was possible for Jude to use one verb in all these places, the meanings translated into natural English require the use of more than one English verb. They were being kept safe.

General Comment on 1d–f

In some languages it may be necessary to use more active verbs to translate 1d–f. For example:

God has called you to believe in him. You are united with God the Father because he loves you. God keeps you safe to present you to Jesus Christ when he returns.

Jude 1:2

Section 1–2: Jude greeted his readers

In New Testament times the common way to begin a letter was to put the writer’s name first, then to mention something about the people who would receive the letter. After that, the writer included a prayer or blessing for their well-being. Jude followed this pattern.

Although Jude did not say where his readers lived, he did say three things about them. These three things are true of all believers:

1. God had called them,
2. God the Father loved them,
3. God would keep them safe for the time when Jesus Christ would return.

In these two verses Jude identified himself as the author of the letter and identified his readers by some of the things that God had done for them. Then he prayed that God would bless them. Jude chose a blessing which related well to the rest of the letter.

2

Mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you.

- May mercy, peace, and love from God be yours^(plur) abundantly.
- I pray that God will be very merciful to you,^(plur) fill you^(plur) with peace, and cause you^(plur) to experience his love for you^(plur) more and more.

Mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you: This is a typical blessing at the beginning of a Greek letter. It is like a prayer that God will provide the readers with mercy, peace, and love. Languages have different ways to express this type of prayer. For example:

I pray that God will greatly bless you with kindness, peace, and love! (CEV)

May you receive more and more of God’s mercy, peace, and love. (NLT)

Mercy: In this context Mercy refers to the compassion and kindness that God shows toward those who need help. It also implies that he gives them the help that they need. See Mercy, Meaning 1, in the Glossary.

peace: The word peace in both Greek and English can refer to two different ideas:

1. It can indicate an inner contentment and serenity. In this context, Jude’s readers could have peace because they knew that God had saved them and that he loved them.
2. It can indicate peaceful relations with other people or with God.

Here Jude probably intended the first of these, inner peace.

love: This is the same kind of love as was mentioned in the note above at 1e. See love, Meaning 1, in the Glossary.

be multiplied to you: The Greek verb that the BSB translates literally here as be multiplied to you may be expressed in English as:

abundantly

greatly

richly

more and more

Here are some options for translating this idea in the context of the whole verse:

- You may be able to translate “mercy,” “peace,” and “love” as nouns in your language. For example:

May mercy, peace and love from God be yours abundantly.

I pray that you will experience more and more of God’s mercy, peace and love.

- You may need to express “mercy,” “peace,” and “love” as verbal ideas. For example:

I pray that more and more God will be merciful to you, make you increasingly peaceful, and cause you to experience more deeply that he loves you.

Jude 1:3

Section 3–4: Jude urged believers to defend the true teaching that they believed

In this section Jude expressed his reason for writing this particular letter. Because ungodly people had come into their church, the Christians to whom Jude was writing had to defend what they believed. These ungodly people were especially dangerous because the true believers had not recognized that the ungodly people were not really Christians. They were “fake” Christians.

3a Beloved,

- ¶ My dear friends,
- ¶ Friends whom I love,

Beloved: Jude used this word to address his readers whom he loved. He used it in this way three times—in 3a, 17a and 20a. Most recent English versions translate it as something similar to “Dear friends.” (NIV, CEV, GW, JBP, NCV, NEB, NJB, NLT, REB, GNT).

Languages may have different types of direct address that would be natural in this context. For example:

Dearly loved friends (NLT)

Look for the most natural way in your language to express the idea. See Love, Meaning 2, in the Glossary.

Languages differ in the most natural placement for a direct address. In some languages it may be most natural to begin the sentence with a direct address like this. In other languages, it is natural to put the direct address after the verb. In your translation, look for the position that is most natural for your language.

3b although I made every effort to write to you

- although I very much wanted to write to you^(plur)
- I had been eagerly planning to write to you^(plur)

I made every effort to write to you: This clause probably indicates that Jude had been planning to write another letter, but that he had not yet started it. The GNT seems to favor the interpretation that Jude had actually started writing the other letter, but then he changed his mind and wrote this letter instead. Some ways to say this are:

I very much wanted to write to you.

I had been eagerly planning to write to you.

I earnestly intended to write to you.

3c about the salvation we share,

- about God’s salvation which we^(incl) all share,
- about what we^(incl) have in common, which is that God has saved us.^(incl)

about the salvation we share: The Greek expression that the BSB translates as about the salvation we share is literally, “about our common salvation.” Jude’s readers had salvation in common, that is, each person had experienced the same salvation. Jude implied that he could have written a letter about the way that God had saved them and what this salvation meant for them.

In some languages it may not be natural to say that people share something like salvation. If that is true in your language, it may be helpful to express this idea in a different way. For example:

about what we^(incl) have in common, which is that God saved us^(incl)

about the salvation that unites us^(incl)

salvation: Through the sacrifice of his son, Jesus Christ (25a, 25c), God had saved Jude and his readers from sin and death and had given them new life. See save, Word 2, in the Glossary.

3d I felt it necessary to write

- I felt compelled to write
- But/However, I must write to you^(plur) instead

I felt it necessary to write: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates as I felt it necessary to is literally, “I had a necessity to.” Jude felt that he must write a different letter than he had first planned to write (3b–c). Some ways to translate this phrase are:

I felt compelled to write

I realized that I must write

I realized that it was/is necessary for me to write

3e

and urge you to contend earnestly for the faith

- to encourage you^(plur) to contend/fight for the truth we^(incl) believe,
- to appeal to you^(plur) to resist false teaching in order to defend the true teaching against the people who oppose it.

and urge you to contend earnestly for the faith:

Jude encouraged his readers to contend...for the faith. The word faith here does not refer to the act of believing, but to what Jude and his readers believed. Jude meant that they were to struggle hard to defend from error the true Christian teaching that they had been taught and had believed. He also meant they were to promote the faith by living according to what it taught them (see verses 20–23).

urge you: Jude told the readers what he wanted them to do in a polite way. He was encouraging them to follow his advice. For example:

to encourage you (NCV)

encouraging you (NJB)

You may be able to translate this as a request. For example:

and ask you (CEV)

to appeal to you

you: In Greek there is no pronoun (you) after the verb that the BSB translates here in 3e as “urge.” In the Greek text, the pronoun (literally “to you”) occurs after the verb “write” in 3d. Literally, it is “write to you.” However, the BSB chose to place the pronoun after the verb “urge” in 3e. You should place the pronoun where

it is most natural in your language. It may be necessary to use a pronoun with both “write” and “urge.”

to contend earnestly: The Greek verb that the BSB translates as to contend is translated by many English versions as “fight.” Modern English versions with a form of “fight” are GW, JBP, NCV, NJB, and GNT. For example:

to fight hard (NJB)

However, Jude did not mean that his readers should fight physically. He was urging them to use all their strength. This Greek verb is *epagōnizomai*. Originally, it spoke of an athlete competing to win, and ability to resist, counteract, and defeat false teaching. Specifically, Jude wanted them to resist the false teaching of the ungodly people whom he would write about in verse 4. He did not want his readers to be harmed by participating in the sinful actions of those ungodly people.

the faith: Here Jude referred to the true Christian teaching as the faith. He called it the faith, because it is what Jude and his readers believed. See faith, Meaning 2, in the Glossary.

3f

entrusted once for all to the saints.

- which was entrusted one time for all time to us^(incl) who are God’s holy/sanctified people.
- God gave this unchanging true teaching to us^(incl), the people who believe in him.

entrusted once for all to the saints: This part of the verse further describes the “faith,” which Jude mentioned in 3e.

once for all: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates as once for all may also be translated as “one time for all times” (see Jude 1:3 in UBS). It indicates that “the faith” is unique and that it does not change. Someone might try to change the faith, the true teaching. The CEV and NLT imply this when they use “to defend” to translate the Greek word which the BSB translates as “contend.” (See the note above for “contend.”) No one is allowed to change it.

To translate once for all, you may be able to find a word or phrase that communicates the three parts of its meaning:

1. God only had to give this faith to the believers one time.
2. Its teachings would never change throughout the rest of time.
3. They were adequate for all times.

Other ways to say this are:

once to last forever

unique and unchangeable throughout all time

entrusted: The Greek verb that the BSB Other versions that translate this as “entrusted” are NIV, GW, NET, NJB, NRSV and REB. translates as entrusted can also be translated as:

delivered (RSV)

committed (JBP)

given (GNT)

The verb implies that the first Christians received the true teachings, and they had the responsibility pass these true teachings faithfully to other people. The text does not say who entrusted the teachings to the first Christians. It could have been God or Jesus or the apostles. If you need to specify who entrusted the teachings to the Christians, it is recommended that you say God.

the saints: The Greek expression that the BSB translates as the saints is literally “the holy (ones)” and means “the holy people.” This expression was used by many New Testament authors to refer to Christians, the people who believe in Jesus Christ. When used in this way, it refers to all Christians, including Jude and his readers. Some ways to translate this phrase are:

God’s holy people.

those who believe/trust in Jesus Christ.

people dedicated to God.

See holy, Meaning 1, in the Glossary.

Jude 1:4

Section 3–4: Jude urged believers to defend the true teaching that they believed

In this section Jude expressed his reason for writing this particular letter. Because ungodly people had come into their church, the Christians to whom Jude was writing had to defend what they believed. These ungodly people were especially dangerous because

the true believers had not recognized that the ungodly people were not really Christians. They were “fake” Christians.

4

In this verse, Jude explained the problem that faced the Christians to whom he was writing. People who did not really believe the truth about God were gathering with the real Christians. They were fake Christians. In verse 4, Jude first mentioned the people who had secretly slipped into the Christian congregation. Jude mentioned them many more times in this letter, but he referred to them with a pronoun, not a name or descriptive phrase. In order to refer to them clearly in these Notes, they are called fake Christians. This matches Jude’s distinctive description of them here in verse 4. Other writers have referred to these people as “false teachers,” “ungodly men,” or “ungodly people.” Each of these has some difficulty: False teachers: While the texts from which Jude chose his illustrations may imply that these people were teachers or leaders, Jude nowhere directly described them as such. The people Jude had in mind may have included some people who were not teachers or leaders. Ungodly men: Were there no women among these fake Christians? Jude does not say specifically. Ungodly men and ungodly people: To call these fake Christians “ungodly men” or “ungodly people” does not distinguish them from other groups of people in this letter. Jude also referred to ungodly people who were not part of this group, for example, the “ungodly” in verse 15. Therefore, in these Notes, “fake Christians” refers to the people whom Jude described as people who had secretly slipped in among the true believers.

In some languages it may be more natural to reorder 4a–c as shown in the Display. The Notes will use this order in the discussion that follows.

4a

For certain men

- I am writing this letter to you^(plur) because some people

For: The Greek conjunction *gar* that the BSB translates here as For connects verse 4 with verse 3. It indicates that verse 4 is a reason for an idea. There are two interpretations as to what this was in verse 3: (1) The presence of these fake Christians was the reason Jude wrote this letter. (2) The presence of these fake Christians was the reason why the true believers needed to contend for the Christian faith. Most English versions are ambiguous, allowing for either interpretation. For languages that must select one of the two interpretations, interpretation (1) is recommended in the Notes, because it implies both interpretations.

Because Jude said in verse 3 that he wrote this letter in order to encourage the readers to contend for the Christian faith, translating according to interpretation (1) implies interpretation (2) as well. In verse 3. If your language requires you to say what that idea is, the context shows that it is the reason that Jude wrote this letter. In order to make this connection clear, you may need to make this explicit. For example:

I am writing these things to you because there are certain men among you...

For languages that normally place the reason first, it may be more natural to change the order of verses 3 and 4. See the general comment on 3–4 at the end of the notes for 4f for an example.

certain men: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as men can also refer to people in general. For example:

Certain people (NJB)

certain persons (NASB)

Some people (GW, NCV)

4b have crept in among you unnoticed—

- who pretend to believe in Jesus Christ have infiltrated your^(plur) group.
- who say they believe in Jesus Christ, but who really do not, have joined your^(plur) congregation/church.

have crept in among you unnoticed: This is a metaphor. Jude used it to describe how the fake Christians had deceived the true Christians. When the fake Christians joined the church, the true Christians were unaware that these fake Christians did not really believe the truth.

unnoticed: Jude indicated here that the fake Christians hid their wrong beliefs when they joined this group of believers. It was not a secret that they had joined the group. Jude's readers did not realize that these fake Christians did not really believe the truth. Some ways to say this are:

^{4a}certain people ^{4b}have infiltrated your group.

^{4a}certain people ^{4b}who pretend to believe have joined your group.

^{4a}certain people, ^{4b}who say they believe, but who really do not, have joined your group.

A general comment at the end of the notes for 4f shows that 4a–f may be reordered, with 4d placed earlier in the verse. In some languages, this may be more natural.

4c ungodly ones

- They do not respect God.
- These people do not acknowledge that God has authority over them.

ungodly ones: Jude described the fake Christians as ungodly, because they did not respect God or his authority. Because these people did not respect God's authority over them, they lived sinful lives. Other ways to say this include:

They do not respect God.

They do not respect the authority of God over them.

ones: The BSB has supplied the word ones to refer to people in general. For example:

godless people (GNT)

ungodly persons (NASB, RSV)

4d who were designated long ago for condemnation.

- Long ago the punishment/doom of these men was written about.
- A long time ago it was written that these men would be condemned.
- The Scriptures that were written long ago say that God will judge and punish them.

who were designated long ago for condemnation: Jude described the people he had mentioned in 4a as people who were designated long ago for condemnation.

were designated: In this context there are several ways to interpret the Greek word that the BSB translates as were designated:

1. It means written about. For example:

the prophets wrote about these people (NCV)
(CEV, GW, NCV, NIV, GNT)

1. It means that either the people or their punishment was designated or determined. For example:

The fate of such people was determined long ago.
(NLT)

who were long beforehand marked out for this condemnation. (NASB) (BSB, KJV, NLT, NRSV, RSV, NASB, NET, NJB)

It is recommended that you follow interpretation (1). Jude probably meant that their condemnation was written about in the Old Testament. This interpretation is used in the Meaning Lines of the Display.

In the main section of this letter, verses 5-19, Jude used many examples from the Old Testament. However, he also used some examples that are not from the Old Testament (see verses 9, 14-15, 17-18). Therefore, it is best not to specify where the condemnation of these people was written about. However, if your language requires you to make explicit where this was written, you may use your key term for “scripture.” For example:

scripture (REB)

the Scriptures (GNT, CEV)

Jude did not mean that the scriptures contained a list of the names of these people. Instead, he meant that God had said in the scriptures that he would punish people who sinned like these people did.

condemnation: The word condemnation refers here to God judging. From the parallel passage of 2 Peter 2:9, Jude was apparently referring to the judgment which God will speak against them on the last day. This is true regardless of which letter was written first. These people and condemning them. This condemnation implies two ideas:

1. God would judge them and pronounce them “guilty” of certain sins. Jude listed these sins in 4e-f.
2. This condemnation also included the punishment that they would receive because of these sins.

Some English versions also imply both of these ideas. For example:

...long ago the Scriptures warned that these godless people were doomed (CEV)

4e-f

In 4e-f, Jude mentioned two ways in which these people showed that they did not respect God.

4e

They turn the grace of our God into a license for immorality,

- They say/believe that since our^(incl) God is kind to people, they may live/behave immorally,
- They use the fact that our^(incl) God forgives people who sin as an excuse for them to continue to sin sexually.

They turn the grace of our God into a license for immorality: These fake Christians were using God’s grace as an excuse to do whatever they wanted to do. They were saying that since God is kind and forgives people when they sin, it was therefore acceptable to continue to behave immorally. Paul spoke against this false teaching in Romans 5:20-6:2.

the grace: In this context, grace refers to God’s kindness towards human beings and his desire to forgive their sins. God showed this kindness by sacrificing his Son, Jesus Christ, to enable people to have fellowship with God. The grace of God made Jesus willing to suffer and die to save human beings from being damned because of their sins. For example, the NLT translates the grace as:

God’s forgiveness (NLT)

See grace in the Glossary.

our God: Several versions omit our (CEV, GW, JBP, NLT). The Greek text includes this idea. Jude referred to God as our God, to indicate the close relationship that he and the true believers had with God.

However, in some languages, using a pronoun like our with God might communicate a wrong meaning, such as:

1. God belonged to Jude and his readers like a possession.
2. There is another god.
3. The fake Christians claimed to worship a different god, other than the true God.

If saying our God might communicate wrong meaning (a), you could say:

the God we worship

God, whom we worship

If saying our God might communicate wrong meaning (b) or (c), you could omit our.

a license for immorality: The fake Christians acted as if they could sin freely. Some other ways this has been translated are:

to excuse their immoral ways (GNT)

an opportunity for immorality (JBP)

a reason for sexual sin (NCV)

allows us to live immoral lives (NLT)

immorality: The immorality to which Jude referred included sexual sin, but also other sins. If your language has a word, phrase, or idiom that definitely includes sexual sin but could also include other sins, it may be a good choice here.

4f

and they deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ.

- and they deny our^(incl) only Ruler and our^(incl) Lord, Jesus Christ.
- They reject Jesus Christ, who is our^(incl) only Master and our^(incl) Lord.

and they deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus

Christ: It is recommended that you do not use the KJV as a model for translating 4f. The KJV followed some copies of the Greek text that contain the word “God” in 4f. However, we can tell from other better copies that “God” was not part of what Jude wrote in 4f. In 4f, Jude mentioned another way that the fake Christians showed that they did not respect God: they denied Jesus Christ.

deny: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as deny means “reject [someone] or refuse to accept [him].” Some ways to translate this are:

reject (NJB)

refuse to accept (NCV)

disowning (REB)

The manner in which these fake Christians were denying Jesus Christ may have been:

1. by what they said, in words only.

2. by their actions, by what they did.
3. by both their words and their actions.

From what Jude wrote in this letter, it is obvious that the fake Christians denied and rejected Jesus by both their words and their actions. Therefore, it is good to use an expression that includes both words and actions. However, if you need to choose between words and actions, it is recommended that you refer to sinful actions.

Christ: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as Christ is part of the name, Jesus Christ, so it should be translated as a name. See Christ in the Glossary.

Master and Lord: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as Master described the someone over the servants or slaves, the head of a household, or a ruler with absolute authority.

The Greek word that the BSB translates as Lord is the word that New Testament writers normally used to speak of Jesus as leader or chief. See Lord in the Glossary.

The two Greek words, translated Master and Lord, have almost the same meaning. Jude used them together to emphasize that Jesus has total or absolute authority.

Try to find two words or phrases in your language that speak about the highest authorities. If possible, make sure that one of these is how you normally refer to Jesus as Lord. However, if you can find only one suitable word or phrase, then translate these two Greek words with one expression.

General Comment on 3–4

As the notes for 4a mentioned, verse 4 gives the reason for verse 3. Because of the fake Christians, Jude felt that he needed to write this letter urging his readers to defend the faith.

In many languages, it is normal to put the reason for an action first. If this is true in your language, you may need to reorder verses 3 and 4. For example:

^{4a}Because certain people ^{4b}who pretend to believe have joined your group, ^{3d}I felt the need to write this letter to you ^{3e}to urge you to defend the faith....

^{4a}However, certain people ^{4b}who say they believe in God, but who really do not, have joined your group. ^{3d}Therefore, I must write ^{3e}to ask you to contend for the faith....

General Comment on 4a–f

In some languages it is more natural to reorder 4a–f, placing 4d later in the verse. There are two options:

- 4d may be placed right after 4b. For example:

^{4a}For certain persons ^{4b}have crept in unnoticed, ^{4d}those who were long beforehand marked out for this condemnation, ^{4c}ungodly persons ^{4e}who turn the grace of our God into licentiousness ^{4f}and deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ. (NASB)

- 4d may be placed after 4f. For example:

^{4a}For some ^{4c}godless people ^{4b}have slipped in unnoticed among us, ^{4e}persons who distort the message about the grace of our God in order to excuse their immoral ways, ^{4f}and who reject Jesus Christ, our only Master and Lord. ^{4d}Long ago the Scriptures predicted the condemnation they have received. (GNT)

Jude 1:5

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians

In this section, Jude described the sins of the fake Christians in more detail. He also foretold that the Lord would punish them. He used a special Jewish style. As mentioned in the Outline, this style was called “midrash.” Jewish rabbis sometimes used this text-application style of presentation in these verses. He referred to different examples, often taken from the Bible. Then he applied these examples to the situation about which he was writing.

Jude organized this part of his letter as follows:

Example	Application
verses 5–7	verse 8 Verse 8 is the application for the examples in 5–7 and could end that paragraph. Verse 8 also introduces 9–10 and could begin that paragraph. These Notes show the paragraph division between verse 7 and verse 8, as does almost every English version.
verse 9	verse 10
verse 11	verses 12–13
verses 14–15	verse 16
verses 17–18	verse 19

The main purpose of the section was to show that the Lord would certainly punish these fake Christians. Jude compared them with well-known individuals and groups mentioned in the Old Testament and in other Jewish writings. He also used things found in nature to describe their sinful ways. Through these examples, he explained that these fake Christians deserved the punishment which they would receive.

Paragraph 5–7

In these verses, Jude reminded his readers about three well-known groups who had sinned, and as a result had suffered terrible punishments:

1. The Israelites had been slaves in Egypt, and the Lord brought them out from there. However, afterwards he destroyed those among them who did not trust in him.
2. Some angels had rebelled against the Lord, so he placed them in chains in a dark place until the day when he would judge them.
3. The people of Sodom and Gomorrah had sinned sexually, so the Lord destroyed them by fire.

5a–b

The general comment at the end of the notes for 5b discusses an issue that affects 5a–b. You will want to consider this issue before you make a final decision about how to translate this verse.

5a

Although you are fully aware of this, I want to remind you that

- ¶ I Although you^(plur) already know all these things/facts, I want to remind you^(plur) that/how
- ¶ I You^(plur) already know all these things/facts, but I want you^(plur) to consider that/how
- ¶ I I want to remind you^(plur) about some things/facts that you^(plur) already know.

Although you are fully aware of this, I want to remind you that:

Jude realized that the three examples which he used in verses 5–7 were familiar to his readers. He was careful to mention that he knew this fact, probably so that he would not offend them. Some ways to express this meaning include:

I want to remind you of some things you already know: (NCV)

Although you already know all these things/facts, I want to remind you that...

I want you to consider some things/facts that you already know.

5b**after Jesus had delivered His people out of the land of Egypt,**

- Jesus rescued a/the people from slavery out of the country of Egypt,
- The Lord once freed/released the Israelite people from being slaves and brought them out from the land of Egypt,

Jesus: There is a textual issue here:

1. Some copies of the Greek text have Lord. For example:

that the Lord, after saving a people (NASB) (CEV, GW, JBP, KJV, NASB, NCV, NIV, NJB, NLT, NRSV, REB, GNT)

1. Other copies of the Greek text have Jesus. For example:

that Jesus, having saved the people (NET) (BSB, NET; notes in NASB, NIV, NLT, NRSV, REB, GNT)

Scholars have different opinions about what Jude originally wrote. While most modern versions follow option (1) and have “Lord,” there is also strong evidence for option (2), Jesus. The NET argues the case for Jude having written “Jesus.” The NET does this in two notes at Jude 5 and another at 1 Corinthians 10:9 for “Christ.” (See Jude 5 in NET and 1 Corinthians 10:9 in NET.) If Jude wrote “Lord,” then in this context (4f), “Lord” would refer to Jesus Christ before he became a human being.

In your translation, you can follow the major language version in your area. If you follow option (1) (“Lord”), it is recommended that you include a footnote saying that Jude may have written Jesus.

had delivered His people out of the land of Egypt:

Jude referred here to the time when the Lord freed the Israelites from slavery in Egypt and led them away from there. This is recorded in the book of Exodus.

had delivered: The Greek verb that the BSB translates here as delivered includes these ideas:

1. to free someone from something bad,
2. to rescue/save,
3. to keep someone safe.

Some ways to translate delivered include:

released

rescued

saved/freed from slavery

His people: The phrase His people refers to the Israelites. The Greek word for His is not explicit in the text. Therefore, you do not need to translate the word His. For example:

a people (NASB)

the people (NET)

the people of Israel (GNT)

out of the land of Egypt: Egypt was the country where the Israelites had been slaves. It was from slavery in this country that the Lord delivered them. It may be more natural in your language to make the idea of slavery explicit. For example:

The Lord rescued his people from slavery, bringing them out of Egypt.

The Lord freed his people from Egypt where they were slaves.

General Comment on 5a–b

The Greek text for verse 5 contains the word hapax. This Greek word can be translated literally as “once” or “once for all.” Many English versions leave it implicit (BSB, CEV, JBP, NCV, NIV, NLT).

Copies of the Greek text differ about where hapax is placed in this verse. This affects which verb hapax relates to. Two options are:

1. It relates to the verb translated as “delivered” in 5b. For example:

The Lord once saved his people from Egypt. (GW) (GW, NRSV, REB, GNT)

1. It relates to the verb translated as “fully aware” in 5a. For example:

you have been fully informed of these facts once for all. (NET) (KJV, NASB, NET, NJB, RSV)

If you translate this Greek word, it is recommended that you follow option (1). Option (1) gives a better

contrast with 5c than option (2) does. Most of the English versions that do not translate hapax probably also follow option (1).

5b–c
after Jesus had delivered His people out of the land of Egypt, He destroyed those who did not believe:
The Greek phrase that the BSB translates here as after is literally “the second” and occurs at the beginning of 5c. With this phrase, Jude indicated that the event in 5c happened after the Lord saved the Israelites out of Egypt. This after action by the Lord contrasts with the saving action he did earlier. Some versions include “but” to indicate this contrast and place the phrase at the beginning of 5c. For example:

^{5b}the Lord rescued the nation from Egypt, ^{5c}but afterwards he still destroyed the people who refused to believe him (NJB)

^{5b}The Lord once saved his people from Egypt.
^{5c}But on another occasion he destroyed those who didn’t believe. (GW)

5c
He destroyed those who did not believe.

- but later he destroyed those among them who did not believe in him.
- but afterwards he killed all of them who did not believe in him.
- but later he caused all of those people who did not trust him to die in the desert.

He destroyed: The Lord destroyed some of the people whom he freed from Egypt. He destroyed them by causing them to die in the wilderness.

those who did not believe: The Lord destroyed those Israelites who did not believe in him. In some languages it is necessary for a verb like believe to have a stated object. For example:

did not believe in him

did not have faith in him

did not trust him

See faith, Meaning 1, in the Glossary.

Jude 1:6
Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians
In this section, Jude described the sins of the fake Christians in more detail. He also foretold that the Lord would punish them. He used a special Jewish styleAs mentioned in the Outline, this style was called “midrash.” Jewish rabbis sometimes used this text-application style of presentation. in these verses. He referred to different examples, often taken from the Bible. Then he applied these examples to the situation about which he was writing.

Jude organized this part of his letter as follows:

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Paragraph 5–7
In these verses, Jude reminded his readers about three well-known groups who had sinned, and as a result had suffered terrible punishments:

1. The Israelites had been slaves in Egypt, and the Lord brought them out from there. However, afterwards he destroyed those among them who did not trust in him.
2. Some angels had rebelled against the Lord, so he placed them in chains in a dark place until the day when he would judge them.
3. The people of Sodom and Gomorrah had sinned sexually, so the Lord destroyed them by fire.

6-7

In some languages it may be helpful to use an introductory phrase at the start of verse 6, and maybe also verse 7. This phrase would be similar to “I want to remind you” in 5a. For example:

⁶ And remember the angels.... ⁷Also remember the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah.... (NCV)

Several other English versions, including the NLT, REB, and GNT, have a phrase like this.

6

In verse 6, Jude gave his second example of a group that sinned against God, and as a result, suffered terrible punishments.

6a**And the angels who did not stay within their own domain**

- And there were angels who did not keep the positions/responsibilities entrusted/delegated to them,
- In addition, I want to remind you^(plur) that the Lord punished even angels. Those angels did not keep their authority/rule that God entrusted/delegated to them,

the angels: Here Jude referred to angels who had rebelled against the Lord. He did not refer to all angels, but only to those who rebelled. See angel, Meaning 2, in the Glossary.

Many other angels have always obeyed God (see angel, Meaning 1, in the Glossary). In some languages, it may be necessary to make it clear that Jude was not referring to all angels. For example, it might be helpful to say:

some angels

certain angels

In other languages, it may be better to put this information in a footnote.

Translators should avoid using a term that implies that angels are the spirits of human beings, either alive or dead.

In the Greek text there is no definite article (the) before the word for angels. Some scholars believe that this emphasizes the high status of angels. Several commentaries understand “angels” without the definite article in this case to be qualitative, emphasizing their high status, or contrasting them with the human beings described in the examples before and after

(verses 5 & 7). The meaning seems to be that the Lord punishes even angels who rebel against him. If a translator wanted to include this, then verse 6 could be started like this: “And the Lord has punished even certain angels....” For example:

And the very angels... (JBP)

who did not stay within their own domain: Jude frequently used the Greek verb, *tēreō*, which the BSB translates as stay. He used a form of *tēreō* in 1f, 6a, 6c, 13d (where the BSB uses the verb “reserved”), and 21a. Though it was possible for Jude to use one verb in all these places, the meanings translated into natural English require the use of more than one English verb. Here Jude described the way in which these angels had sinned. God had given authority to the angels by giving each of them certain responsibilities. The angels whom Jude mentioned here rebelled. They left their own domains, refusing to fulfill the responsibilities which God had assigned to them. Some other ways to say this include:

didn’t do their work (CEV)

refused to do their duty

Jude did not say why these angels left their positions of authority. Most English versions also do not state the reason (BSB, CEV, GW, JBP, KJV, NASB, NCV, NIV, NJB, NRSV, RSV). A few English versions have indicated that they abandoned these positions because they were not content or felt limited in some way. English versions that indicate a reason why these angels abandoned their positions of authority are: NET, NLT, REB and GNT. For example:

who did not stay within the limits of their proper authority (GNT)

who were not content to maintain the dominion assigned to them, (REB)

their own domain: In this context the Greek word *archē*, which the BSB translates as domain means “rule” or “positions of authority.” It indicates that these angels were in charge of something. However, they had received each domain from God, and they were accountable to him. You may be able to use a term that describes the kind of authority that a king or chief gives to someone else to manage his wealth or property.

6b but abandoned their proper dwelling—

- but instead they abandoned their own proper areas/ domains.
- but instead they deserted their assigned/proper places.

but: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as but marks contrast. The contrast is:

^{6a} having their own domain

but

^{6b} abandoned the places where they have that domain

In some languages, it may be more natural to connect 6a and 6b in a different way. A conjunction like “and” would indicate connection and similarity between:

^{6a} not keeping their own domain

“and”

^{6b} abandoning the places where they have that domain

For example:

didn’t do their work and left their proper places.
(CEV)

failed in their high duties and abandoned their proper sphere (JBP)

abandoned their proper dwelling: The Greek word *oikētērion* occurs only twice in the New Testament. The only other use of *oikētērion* in the New Testament is by Paul in 2 Corinthians 5:2. There the BSB translates this word as “dwelling.” The context in 2 Corinthians is talking about the resurrection body. Here it includes two ideas:

1. Its literal meaning is home. In this verse, it implies that the angels left their place of residence. For example:

abandoned their own place of residence (NET)

abandoned their own dwelling place (GNT)

1. It has an extended meaning that includes the activities that should occur at a home or place. In this context, these angels abandoned their places, including the activities that God had assigned to them to do. Louw and Nida, classify *oikētērion* as one of the Greek words that imply “abandoned their proper dwelling.” (Subdomain E, starting at 85.67, footnote 864.) For example:

abandoned their assigned place. (GW)

abandoned their proper sphere (JBP)

The second meaning is more in focus in this context. In your translation, it will be helpful to use an expression that includes this idea. If your language has a word or phrase which, like *oikētērion*, can mean home or place of residence, but also implies the activities that happen there, you may be able to use it here. Such an expression will also help to indicate that both 6a and 6b describe the way that these angels rebelled against God.

abandoned: In this context, the Greek word that the BSB translates here as abandoned means “left completely.” These angels left permanently. Try to avoid using a verb that would cause your readers to think that these angels left but intended to return later.

6c these He has kept in eternal chains under darkness,

- He has kept these angels in chains that no one can break in a place of darkness,
- The Lord has put these angels in a dark place, and he still keeps them there so securely that they can never free themselves.

these: The word *these* refers to the angels about whom Jude wrote in 6a–b. The BSB has supplied the word *these* in order to help clarify that the actions in 6c–d happened to these angels.

He has kept in eternal chains under darkness: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as under can mean that these angels were under the control of darkness, that is, unable to escape it. Jude did not explain what he meant by darkness. However, it is clear that the Lord put these angels in some kind of dark prison/place and kept them there. This agrees with what Jude mentioned about eternal chains in this verse.

In some languages, it may be necessary to mention first that the Lord put the angels under darkness before saying that he kept them there. For example:

He put them in darkness, and he has kept them there.

The Lord put these angels in a dark place where he still keeps them.

He: The Greek text of this verse does not contain either “God” or “Lord.” The English versions refer to the agent, i.e. who it was who “kept” the angels in darkness, in three different ways. He (BSB, GW, KJV, NASB, NET, NIV, NJB, NRSV)-or-the Lord (NCV)-or-God (CEV, JBP, NLT, REB, GNT). The pronoun He refers back to “Jesus” in 5b. If it is not natural or not clear to use the pronoun He here, then you may say “the Lord.” For example:

The Lord has kept these angels in darkness. (NCV)

has kept: Jude frequently used the Greek verb, *tēreō*, that the BSB translates as kept. He used a form of *tēreō* in 1f, 6a, 6c, 13d (where the BSB uses the verb “reserved”), and 21a. Though it was possible for Jude to use one verb in all these places, the meanings translated into natural English require the use of more than one English verb. In this verse, Jude used a play on words. The Greek verb that the BSB translates here as has kept is a form of the verb that was translated “stay” in 6a. In this way, Jude used a type of irony: the angels would not “keep” their proper places so the Lord has kept them in a place of punishment.

In some languages, it may be possible to express the irony in a similar way. However, in some languages it may not be natural to use the same verb in both of these contexts. If that is true in your language, you may express the irony in another way or let it be implied by the context. If it is not natural to do this through the verb, the translator may be able to express irony through the use of “place,” that is, “abandoned their place” (6b) versus “place of darkness” (6c).

in eternal chains: When Jude wrote this letter, it was common to restrain prisoners. Jude used this practice to describe a spiritual reality. These angels were deprived of freedom. It was impossible for them to escape.

chains: The chains used in Jude’s time were made of strong metal. In some cultures people may not be

familiar with the practice of using chains to bind or restrain someone. If that is true in your culture, it may be better to use a more general expression. For example:

restrained

imprisoned

bound with steel

tied securely

6d bound for judgment on that great day.

- They are bound/tied there and waiting to be judged on the great day.
- He has bound/tied them there until the great day when he will judge them.

bound: The BSB has supplied the verb bound. When talking about chains, bound is a more natural verb in English than “has kept” in 6c. The verb “has kept” in 6c applies also to 6d.

For some languages, it is more natural to use an active verb and specify who imprisoned the angels. The note for “he” in 6c explains that the Lord imprisoned them in this way. For example:

he has bound them...

for judgment on that great day: The Lord has imprisoned these angels in darkness until the time comes for them to be judged. This will happen on what Jude called that great day.

The Greek word that the BSB translates here as for can refer to time. In this case, it can mean until the great Day. For example:

until the judgment of the great day. (RSV, JBP) The NJB has the same wording, but capitalizes the D of Day, that is, “the great Day.”

until the great day of judgment. (CEV)

waiting for the day of judgment. (NLT)

judgment: The outcome of this judgment was not in doubt. The judgment which Jude referred to here

included condemnation and punishment for rebelling against God. In some languages, it may be better to use a more specific word, like “condemned.” For example:

that great Day on which they will be condemned.
(GNT)

that great day: The phrase that great day refers to the day when Christ will deliver the final judgment on angels and people. In other places in the Bible, this day is referred to as, “the great and glorious day of the Lord” (Acts 2:20), and “the great day of God Almighty” (Revelation 16:14).

General Comment on 6a–e

In some languages it may be clearer to reorder this verse. For example:

^{6a}And the Lord punished certain angels. ^{6c}He has put them in a dark place, and he keeps them there in everlasting chains, ^{6d}waiting to be judged on the great Day. ^{6a}These are the angels who did not keep their positions of authority. ^{6b}Instead they abandoned their place. In 6c, the note on “has kept” explains that Jude expressed irony through his use of the same Greek verb. If it is not natural to do this through the verb, the translator may be able to express irony through use of “place,” that is, “abandoned their place” (6b) versus “place of darkness” (6c).

Jude 1:7

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians

In this section, Jude described the sins of the fake Christians in more detail. He also foretold that the Lord would punish them. He used a special Jewish styleAs mentioned in the Outline, this style was called “midrash.” Jewish rabbis sometimes used this text-application style of presentation. in these verses. He referred to different examples, often taken from the Bible. Then he applied these examples to the situation about which he was writing.

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The main purpose of the section was to show that the Lord would certainly punish these fake Christians. Jude compared them with well-known individuals and groups mentioned in the Old Testament and in other Jewish writings. He also used things found in nature to describe their sinful ways. Through these examples, he explained that these fake Christians deserved the punishment which they would receive.

Paragraph 5–7

In these verses, Jude reminded his readers about three well-known groups who had sinned, and as a result had suffered terrible punishments:

1. The Israelites had been slaves in Egypt, and the Lord brought them out from there. However, afterwards he destroyed those among them who did not trust in him.
2. Some angels had rebelled against the Lord, so he placed them in chains in a dark place until the day when he would judge them.
3. The people of Sodom and Gomorrah had sinned sexually, so the Lord destroyed them by fire.

7
(BSB:) In like manner, Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, who indulged in sexual immorality and pursued strange flesh, are on display as an example of those who sustain the punishment of eternal fire.

In verse 7, Jude gave a third example of a group who sinned against God, and as a result, suffered terrible punishment. The people of Sodom and Gomorrah sinned sexually. The Lord destroyed them by fire.

In some languages, it may be helpful to use an introductory phraseAs mentioned in the note for 6–7, this is also true for the start of verse 6. at the beginning of verse 7. You may use a phrase that is similar to the phrase, “I want to remind you,” in 5a.

The notes for verse 7 are based on a literal translation of the Greek text, instead of on the BSB. (Notice the abbreviation “lit.” before the words and phrases in the notes below.) Some of the parts of the verse have been reordered to give the notes a more natural order for

English. The letters of the verse parts will follow the new order, which is indicated here:

^{7a}In a similar way to these, ^{7b}Sodom and Gomorrah and the towns around them ^{7c}are exhibited as an example of eternal fire, ^{7d}the penalty they experience, ^{7e}having committed sexual sin and gone after different flesh.

**7a (reordered)
(lit:) In a similar way to these,**

- Like these people and angels,
- Consider/Remember another example, which is similar to these unbelieving Israelites and the angels who rebelled.

Verse 7 begins with the Greek word, *hōs*. It can be translated in a variety of ways, including “that” and “how.” In this context Jude used *hōs* to mark the beginning of this third example of punishment for sin. Lenski (page 621) thought that Jude used *hos* here, instead of the *hoti* (5a) that governs both 5 and 6, because the evidence of what had happened to Sodom and Gomorrah could still be seen. The examples in 5 and 6 were known only through their stories being written or told. However, Jude’s readers could still find evidence of God’s punishment of Sodom and Gomorrah at the south end of the Dead Sea. As the Greek present tense verb *prokeintai* implies, Sodom and Gomorrah are an example that has observable evidence. It indicates that it should be considered along with the first two examples in verse 5 and verse 6. Some ways to express this include:

Also consider that...

You also know how...

I want to remind you that...

(lit.) In a similar way to these: In order to translate verse 7, a translator must decide two issues of interpretation:

Issue 1:

Scholars have different opinions about who these refers to. The two main possibilities are: Two other interpretations that are sometimes suggested are: (3) It refers to either the men of Sodom and Gomorrah or to the men of the surrounding towns, one of these groups being compared to the other. (4) It refers to the fake Christians (verse 4). In the Greek text, “these” is

marked for both gender and number as masculine and plural. Interpretation (3) is unlikely because the Greek words for “Sodom and Gomorrah” and also for “towns” are not masculine. While some scholars suggest that “these” refers to the men in the towns, there is no compelling reason to assume this. It would require Jude to have linked the sin of Sodom and Gomorrah with the sin of the surrounding towns in a very indirect and unnecessarily complicated way. Finally, interpretation (4) is not correct. In verse 8, Jude definitely wrote about the same fake Christians as in verse 4. If “these” in verse 7 also referred to these same people, then Jude would have been repeating himself in verse 8 for no apparent reason.

1. It refers to both the angels whom Jude mentioned in verse 6 and to the Israelites who did not believe and were destroyed (verse 5).
2. It refers to just the angels (verse 6).

Greek grammar would allow either interpretation. In the Greek text, “these” is marked for both gender and number as masculine and plural. “Angels” is the closest preceding noun that is marked as masculine and plural. The unbelieving Israelites are also marked as masculine and plural. But interpretation (1) is more likely because the conjunction used to join verses 5 and 6 indicates a close relationship between these verses. If there is a natural way to include both the angels and unbelieving Israelites in your translation, then it is recommended that you use it here. For example:

In a similar way to these unbelieving Israelites and angels

Issue 2:

Another interpretation issue is to decide in what way the people of Sodom and Gomorrah (7b) were similar to the preceding two groups. This assumes that interpretation (1) above is correct. Which were:

1. the angels who rebelled (verse 6),
2. the unbelieving Israelites (verse 5).

The two main possibilities are:

1. The three groups were similar because all were examples and warnings that the Lord punishes sinners. For example:

We should also be warned by what happened to the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah.... (CEV)

What happened to Sodom and Gomorrah...is an example...of the punishment.... The people of these cities suffered the same fate that God's people and the angels did.... (GW) (CEV, GW, NLT)

1. The sexual sin committed by the people of Sodom and Gomorrah, was similar in nature to the sins that the angels. Scholars who accept this view interpret Genesis 6:1-4 as talking about angelic beings taking human wives. No clear biblical evidence exists that angels are capable of having sexual relations with human beings or that angels and human beings have had children together. and the unbelieving Israelites. While the Israelites who left Egypt did commit sexual sin (Exodus 32:6, Numbers 25:1), verse 5 probably referred to what happened to the Israelites who refused to follow the advice of Joshua and Caleb. They died in the desert because they refused to enter the land that God was giving to them. had committed. According to this interpretation, Jude used three examples of sexual sin. For example:

Sodom and Gomorrah...which, in the same manner as they, indulged in sexual immorality and pursued unnatural lust... (NRSV) It is possible that the NRSV is comparing the people of Sodom and Gomorrah only to the angels, and not to the Israelites that Jude mentioned. Other English versions that clearly compare the people of Sodom and Gomorrah to the angels but not to the Israelites, are the NET, REB and GNT. All four of these versions imply that Jude was indicating sexual immorality as a similarity between the people of Sodom and Gomorrah and the angels.) (NRSV)

It is recommended that you follow interpretation (1).

7b (reordered)

(lit.) Sodom and Gomorrah and the towns around them,

- Sodom and Gomorrah and the neighboring towns
- What happened to the people of Sodom and Gomorrah and the towns near them

(lit.) Sodom and Gomorrah: Jude reminded his readers of what happened to the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah. God destroyed these cities with fire because of the sexually immoral behavior of the people who lived there. You may read about this in Genesis 18:20-22, 19:1-29.

It was not just the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah themselves (with the buildings and possessions) that

were destroyed. All the people who lived there were killed. In some languages it may help to make this explicit. For example:

the people of Sodom and Gomorrah

(lit.) and the towns around them: This phrase refers to the towns near Sodom and Gomorrah that God destroyed at the same time. The names of two of these towns were Admah and Zeboiim (Deuteronomy 29:23). Another nearby town named Zoar was spared. Some ways to say this include:

and the neighboring towns

and the surrounding towns

and the towns that were nearby

7c-d (reordered)

(lit.) are exhibited as an example of eternal fire, the penalty they experience: Scholars have different opinions about how the expression eternal fire relates to the other words in this verse. The two main interpretations are:

1. eternal fire relates primarily to the word example in 7c. What happened to the people of Sodom and Gomorrah was an example and warning that sinful people will be punished by eternal fire in hell. For example:

are a warning of the eternal fire that will punish all who are evil. (NLT) (GW, JBP, NLT)

1. Eternal fire relates primarily to the word penalty in 7d. Sodom and Gomorrah and the towns were experiencing the penalty of eternal fire. Many scholars who accept interpretation (2) do not think that Jude meant the eternal fire of hell. According to them, the eternal fire is the fire whose smoke could still be seen at the south end of the Dead Sea, where these cities once stood. For example:

are put before us as an example since they are paying the penalty of eternal fire. (NJB) (BSB, KJV, NASB, NCV, NET, NJB, REB, RSV, GNT)

The Greek grammar of this verse allows for either or both to be correct. It is recommended that, if possible, you translate as if both interpretations. Jude and his readers were very aware that these cities were

destroyed by fire. Implicit in his example is the manner in which God destroyed these cities. The horrible fire that God used in this destruction made Sodom and Gomorrah especially fitting as an illustration or example of what the end will be for all who continue in willful sin—the eternal fire of hell. are correct. However, if you must choose between them, it is recommended that you follow interpretation (1), which has more support in the commentaries.

The following examples show how this verse may be translated with both interpretations.

Like these people and angels, Sodom and Gomorrah and the surrounding towns are a warning of eternal fire, the penalty they suffer because they committed sexual sin and went after different flesh.

In a similar way to these unbelieving Israelites and angels, Sodom and Gomorrah and the surrounding towns are exhibited as an example of the punishment of eternal fire. Their people suffer the penalty of eternal fire, because they committed sexual sin and went after different flesh.

7c (reordered)
(lit.) are exhibited as an example of eternal fire,

- warn us of eternal fire,
- is an apparent warning of the punishment of eternal fire.
- is a warning which is plain to see that sinful people will be punished by eternal fire.

(lit.) are exhibited as an example: Other ways to translate this include:

they are an apparent/clear example.

they...are now displayed as an example. (NET)

By looking at them, people can see that...

In some languages, it may be better to say explicitly that this type of example is a warning. For example:

Those cities...are a warning... (NLT)

as a plain warning... (GNT)

(lit.) eternal fire: This expression refers to the eternal fire of hell. It is recommended that you not indicate explicitly that this refers to hell, unless that is necessary in your language.

7d (reordered)
(lit:) the penalty they experience,

- which is the penalty that they are paying,
- This punishment of eternal fire is what they are suffering
- That is how the people of Sodom, Gomorrah, and the nearby towns are being punished

(lit.) the penalty they experience: Sodom and Gomorrah and the surrounding towns were destroyed by fire. At the time when Jude wrote this letter, people could still see evidence of this punishment. They could go to the Dead Sea and see signs of destruction where those cities had been.

However, the penalty for the people who lived there involved more than their death at the time when the cities were destroyed. They were also to spend eternity in the fire of hell. That is an even greater penalty, and Jude may have been thinking of it also.

(lit.) penalty: Their penalty was punishment for their sins (7e).

(lit.) they experience: What they experience is punishment. In some languages, it may be more natural to indicate explicitly that this is an experience of punishment or suffering. For example:

they suffer the punishment (GNT)

undergoing a punishment (RSV)

they are paying the penalty (NJB)

7e (reordered)
(lit:) having committed sexual sin and gone after different flesh.

- since they committed sexual sin and followed their unnatural lusts.
- because they habitually indulged in immoral sex and engaged in homosexual acts.

(lit.) having committed sexual sin and gone after different flesh: Jude gave the information in this part of the verse as the reason that God punished the people of Sodom and Gomorrah and the neighboring towns. They were guilty of sexual sin. Their sexual immorality was so bad that God caused them and their

cities to be destroyed. Some ways to indicate this reason are:

because they committed sexual sins and... (GW)

since they indulged in sexual immorality and... (NET)

Jude was probably referring to sexual sin that the people of Sodom and Gomorrah did regularly. It was the habit of these people to sin sexually. If your language normally marks habitual action, you may do so here. For example:

habitually/regularly committed sexual sin

(lit.) having committed sexual sin: This phrase is a literal translation of one Greek word. It could refer to any kind of sexual sin. Look for the most natural way in your language to refer to sexual sin in general, rather than to a specific type of sexual sin.

(lit.) gone after different flesh: Pursuing different flesh was the way that Jude referred to homosexual acts;Scholars have different opinions concerning what sin Jude described as “having gone after different flesh.” The main interpretations are:(1) It refers to homosexual acts; that is, men having sex with men. (2) It refers to bestiality.(3) It refers to the men of Sodom trying to have sex with the two angels who visited Lot (Genesis chapter 19).It is recommended that you follow interpretation (1). Many scholars say that this going after different flesh was homosexual acts, and they are probably correct.The last interpretation is unlikely, because God had already decided to destroy Sodom and Gomorrah and the surrounding town before the incident with the angels at Lot’s house happened. Also, only the men of Sodom tried to have sex with the angels, and God destroyed more than Sodom. In addition, there is no evidence that the men of Sodom knew that the two visitors to Lot’s house were angels. Another reason to reject this last opinion is that Jude said that these men went after different “flesh,” and angels are spirit beings who do not have “flesh.” that is, men having sex with other men. Some ways that English versions have translated this include:

engaged in homosexual activities. (GW)

indulged in unnatural lust (RSV)

sexual relations that God does not allow. (NCV)

Languages often have more than one way to refer to this type of sexual activity. Look for the most natural way in your language that is suitable for reading in worship meetings where people of all ages and both sexes may be present. See flesh in the Glossary.

Jude 1:8

Section 5-19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians

In this section, Jude described the sins of the fake Christians in more detail. He also foretold that the Lord would punish them. He used a special Jewish styleAs mentioned in the Outline, this style was called “midrash.” Jewish rabbis sometimes used this text-application style of presentation. in these verses. He referred to different examples, often taken from the Bible. Then he applied these examples to the situation about which he was writing.

Jude organized this part of his letter as follows:

Example	Application
verses 5-7	verse 8Verse 8 is the application for the examples in 5-7 and could end that paragraph. Verse 8 also introduces 9-10 and could begin that paragraph. These Notes show the paragraph division between verse 7 and verse 8, as does almost every English version.
verse 9	verse 10
verse 11	verses 12-13
verses 14-15	verse 16
verses 17-18	verse 19

The main purpose of the section was to show that the Lord would certainly punish these fake Christians. Jude compared them with well-known individuals and groups mentioned in the Old Testament and in other Jewish writings. He also used things found in nature to describe their sinful ways. Through these examples, he explained that these fake Christians deserved the punishment which they would receive.

Paragraph 8-10

In this paragraph, Jude wrote that the fake Christians (verse 4) had sinned in ways which were similar to the examples of sin in verses 5-7. Jude added another example to show how evil and unwise these people were (verse 9). He then said that they were like unthinking animals (verse 10).

8a**Yet in the same way these dreamers**

- ¶ Nevertheless, in a similar way, these men, because of what they dream,
- ¶ Despite knowing about these examples, these men sin in similar ways, saying that what they dream permits them to do so.
- ¶ Even though they know these things, these people who have joined your^(plur) group sin in similar ways. They claim that God tells them certain things in their dreams, and so

Yet: The Greek text of this verse contains the word *mentoi*, which the BSB translates as Yet. This word helps to show how verse 8 relates to verses 5-7. Normally, it means “nevertheless.” In some languages this meaning may be implied without a connector, so some translations have left the connection implicit. In other languages a connecting word or phrase may help to make the connection clear.

Some other ways to translate *mentoi* here are:

Nevertheless...

Even though they know these things...

Despite knowing about these examples/warnings...

in the same way: The fake Christians whom Jude wrote about in verse 4 sinned in a manner which was similar to the three examples in verses 5-7. However, they did not commit exactly the same sins.

Some other ways that the English versions say this include:

in a similar way (GW)

in like manner (RSV)

in the very same way (NIV)

these dreamers: The phrase these dreamers refers to the fake Christians whom Jude had introduced in verse 4. Look for the most natural way in your language to indicate that these dreamers refers to the same people as the “certain men” (BSB) in verse 4.

Some English versions make this explicit. For example:

It is the same with these people who have entered your group. They are guided by dreams... (NCV)

Yet, in a similar way, the people who slipped in among you are dreamers. (GW)

dreamers: In this verse, Jude described these people as dreamers. They had dreams which they claimed were from God. They thought that these dreams gave them the authority to sin in the ways that Jude mentioned in this verse. However, these dreams were not really from God.

Some ways that English versions have expressed this include:

as a result of their dreams (NET)

who claim authority from their dreams (NLT)

8b**defile their bodies,**

- contaminate/defile their bodies with sexual sin,
- They sin sexually,
- they use their bodies to sin,

defile their bodies: Most scholars agree that defile their bodies refers to sexual sin. This phrase is a figure of speech. Jude was not saying that their bodies were physically dirty. Instead he meant that their sexual sin had made them spiritually impure. Because these people sinned sexually, they were similar to the people of Sodom and Gomorrah (verse 7).

If your language has a similar idiom that associates “being dirty” with “sin,” especially sexual sin, then you may be able to use it here. However, in some languages an expression like “dirty with sin” might simply mean that these people were physically dirty and that they had sinned. If this is true in your language, then you may:

- Use an idiom that has the correct meaning in your language.
- Use a descriptive phrase with the correct meaning. For example:

contaminate/defile themselves with sexual sin

live immoral lives

act immorally

sin sexually

8c reject authority,

- reject the Lord's authority,
- they defy the Lord,

reject authority: Scholars have different opinions concerning whose authority or what kind of authority these fake Christians rejected. The two main interpretations are:

1. Jude meant divine authority. For example:

reject the Lord's authority (GW) (GW, NCV, NET note, NJB, GNT)

1. Jude meant authority in general, including human authority. For example:

reject all authority (CEV) (CEV)

Many English versions do not specify what kind of authority Jude meant. Jude probably intended interpretation (1), that these people rejected the Lord's authority. The discussion of Jude 8 in the UBS Handbook points out: "The word for 'authority,' *kuriotēta*, is related to the word for Lord, *kurios*. It is likely therefore that reject authority here is equivalent in meaning to 'deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ' in verse 4f."

Some languages require a translator to specify whose authority or what type of authority Jude meant. If you need to be specific in your translation, it is recommended that you specify:

the Lord's authority The NET has this note: "Most likely, the authority of the Lord is in view. This verse, then, echoes the indictment of v. 4: 'they deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ.'"

However, if you have a suitable way in your language to refer to all types of authority, including divine authority, you may use it here.

8d and slander glorious beings.

- and scorn his glories.
- and they lie against/about our^(incl) glorious Lord.
- and they usurp/assume the Lord's authority.

slander: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as slander is literally "blaspheme." "Blaspheme" means to insult someone in a way that could injure

their reputation. In English, "blaspheme" would generally apply to a deity, and "slander" to other personal beings, such as angels, human beings, and possibly Jesus according to his human nature. It is often used to refer to evil or irreverent statements about God, divine beings, or holy things. It can also mean to insult or disrespect God by saying or doing something that only God has the right or ability to say or do.

glorious beings: The Greek word *doxas* in its plural accusative form, *doxas*, occurs only three times in the New Testament (1 Peter 1:11, 2 Peter 2:10, Jude 8). 2 Peter 2:10 is a parallel passage to Jude 8, and it is likely that the intended meaning is the same in both passages. 1 Peter 1:11 does not refer to angels, but rather to the glorious attributes associated with Jesus Christ. If 1 Peter and 2 Peter have a common author, then it can be assumed that divine attributes are meant in 2 Peter 2:10, and also in the parallel passage, Jude 8. that the BSB translates here as glorious beings is literally the noun "glories." Scholars have different opinions concerning what Jude meant by "glories." Two different interpretations are:

1. It refers to the glories of Jesus Christ; that is, to what he has done and to what he is like in his splendor and excellence. For example:

his glory (GW) (GW, NJB)

1. It refers to angels, or to some type of angel. For example:

the angels (NCV) (BSB, CEV, NASB, NCV, NET, NIV, REB, GNT)

It is recommended that you follow interpretation (1). "Glories" has this meaning in 1 Peter 1:11. There it refers to the glorious attributes associated with Jesus Christ after his suffering on earth ended. The general comment for 8d explains this in more detail. See also glory, Meaning 3, in the Glossary.

In modern English it is more natural to use the singular form of the noun "glory." English versions of 1 Peter 1:11 often translate the plural noun *doxas* by singular noun "glory" (GW, KJV, NCV, NET, NLT, NRSV, RSV, GNT). For example:

the Lord's glory

General Comment on 8d

Jude did not specify exactly what these fake Christians did. They probably claimed that they spoke with the

Lord’s authority. Actually, they opposed his true will by lying in order to justify their evil actions. (See the notes on “these dreamers” and “dreamers” in 8a.)

In this way, the fake Christians spoke falsely about the Lord and insulted him. They may also have usurped his authority by passing judgment on other people in his name, or by opposing those who taught the truth.

The situation that Jude most likely referred to was that the fake Christians “blasphemed glories” by speaking with authority that belonged only to the Lord. This seems even more likely when verse 9 is considered, as well as 2 Peter 2:11. In 2 Peter 2:11, the judgment that angels do not bring is specified as “from the Lord.” A textual variant has, “before the Lord.” Either way, the angels are unwilling to speak a judgment that is the Lord’s to speak or to judge. Some ways to translate this include:

- and insult/disrespect the Lord’s glory
- and they lie against/about our glorious Lord.
- and they usurp the Lord’s authority.

Jude 1:9

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians

In this section, Jude described the sins of the fake Christians in more detail. He also foretold that the Lord would punish them. He used a special Jewish style. As mentioned in the Outline, this style was called “midrash.” Jewish rabbis sometimes used this text-application style of presentation in these verses. He referred to different examples, often taken from the Bible. Then he applied these examples to the situation about which he was writing.

Jude organized this part of his letter as follows:

Example	Application
verses 5–7	verse 8Verse 8 is the application for the examples in 5–7 and could end that paragraph. Verse 8 also introduces 9–10 and could begin that paragraph. These Notes show the paragraph division between verse 7 and verse 8, as does almost every English version.
verse 9	verse 10
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The main purpose of the section was to show that the Lord would certainly punish these fake Christians. Jude compared them with well-known individuals and groups mentioned in the Old Testament and in other Jewish writings. He also used things found in nature to describe their sinful ways. Through these examples, he explained that these fake Christians deserved the punishment which they would receive.

Paragraph 8–10

In this paragraph, Jude wrote that the fake Christians (verse 4) had sinned in ways which were similar to the examples of sin in verses 5–7. Jude added another example to show how evil and unwise these people were (verse 9). He then said that they were like unthinking animals (verse 10).

9

Deuteronomy 34:5–6 says that the Lord buried Moses in the land of Moab. Jude referred in verse 9 to a story about this event. The story, called “the Assumption of Moses,” is not in the Bible. We know about it from other sources. We do not have a copy of the Assumption of Moses. The story has been pieced together from several sources. Jude’s readers probably knew this story.

Here is a summary of the story:

After Moses died, the Lord told the leading angel, Michael, to bury Moses’ body, but the devil argued with Michael. The devil said that Michael did not have the right to take the body and bury it. The devil argued that he himself could claim the body. The devil argued that he had a right to claim Moses’ body, because Moses had murdered an Egyptian. However, Michael refused to give the body to the devil. Michael did not pronounce judgment on the devil, because the Lord alone had the authority to judge. For a reconstructed outline of this story see Kistemaker, page 386.

9a

But even the archangel Michael,

- But even the chief angel Michael,
- But even Michael, leader among God’s angels, did not do that.

But even: Jude contrasted the evil actions of the fake Christians with the correct action of the archangel Michael.

the archangel Michael: Archangels are angels who lead other angels. Michael is the only archangel men-

tioned by name in the Bible. Some ways to translate archangel are:

leading angel

chief angel

leader of God's angels

9b

when he disputed with the devil over the body of Moses,

- when he argued/contended with the devil about which of them had the right to take the body of Moses,
- When he disputed with the devil about whether it was right for Michael to take the body of Moses and bury it,

The general comment at the end of the notes for 9d shows a way in which the parts of this verse may be reordered. Putting 9b at the end of the verse may be more natural in some languages.

when he disputed with the devil over the body of Moses: Michael and the devil disputed about which of them had a right to take the body of Moses. For more detail, see the introductory note at the beginning of verse 9.

disputed: The Greek text has two verbs here in 9b that express almost the same idea. The text is literally:

when with the devil disputing, he was arguing about the body of Moses.

The two Greek verbs were often used when talking about legal disputes. They do not simply mean that Michael and Satan quarreled. If your language has terms for a disagreement concerning the law, then it may be appropriate to use them here. The term(s) you select should not imply that Michael and the devil fought physically.

Since the two Greek verbs have almost the same meaning, English versions that translate each of the two Greek verbs separately include: GW, JBP, KJV, NASB, NET, NRSV, RSV, GNT. We can see how close in meaning the two Greek verbs are by comparing how these versions translated each Greek verb. Here are versions which translate the first verb, *diakrinomenos*, with a form of the following verbs: argue (GW, NET)-or-contend (JBP, KJV, NRSV, RSV)-or-dispute (NASB). These versions translate the second Greek verb, *dielegeto*,

with a form of these verbs: argue (GW, NASB, GNT)-or-dispute (JBP, KJV, NRSV, RSV) there are two basic options for translation:

- Translate the two Greek verbs separately. For example:

when he disputed with the devil and argued about the body of Moses (NASB)

In his quarrel with the Devil, when they argued about who would have the body of Moses (GNT)

- Use one expression to translate the idea of both Greek verbs, as the BSB and some other English versions have done. English versions that use one verb to translate the idea of both Greek verbs include: BSB, CEV, NCV, NIV, NJB, NLT, REB. They used a form of one of the following: argue (CEV, NCV, NJB, NLT)-or-dispute (BSB, NIV, REB). For example:

when the two of them were arguing about the body of Moses. (CEV)

Look for the most natural way in your language to translate the idea that these two Greek verbs express. In the Display, only one verb is used.

the devil: Jude referred to Satan, the leader of the fallen angels, as the devil here. The devil is the chief enemy of God and the most evil spiritual being. See devil in the Glossary.

9c

did not presume to bring a slanderous charge against him,

- he did not presume to scorn the Lord by judging the devil.
- he would not usurp the Lord's authority by condemning the devil,
- he would not dare to assume authority to judge the devil.

did not presume: The Greek verb that the BSB translates as presume means "to be bold enough [to do something]." In this context Michael was not "bold enough" to judge the devil because he knew that only the Lord had that authority.

The text does not imply that Michael would have judged the devil if he were bolder. Nor does the text imply that Michael was afraid of the devil. Rather, it meant that Michael refused to use authority which belonged only to the Lord. Another way to say this is:

did not dare to condemn him...by judging the devil.

to bring a slanderous charge: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates as to bring a slanderous charge is literally, “to pronounce a judgment of blasphemy.” Scholars have different opinions about who was blaspheming here and against whom the blasphemy was made. Three ways to interpret this phrase are:

1. It means that Michael did not dare to judge the devil or condemn him. Only the Lord had that authority. If Michael had done it, that would have been blasphemy against the Lord. For example:

Michael didn’t dare to hand down a judgment against the devil. (GW)

Not even...Michael...dared to judge the devil guilty. (NCV) (GW, NCV, UBS) Jude meant that Michael did not dare to condemn the devil, because pronouncing judgment against the devil would be blasphemy against the Lord. For anyone besides the Lord to make this kind of judgment is, by nature, blasphemy. Apparently, that is the reason why the NCV and GW make blasphemy implicit in their translations. See also the discussion of Jude 9 in the UBS Handbook.

1. It means that Michael did not dare to slander (“blaspheme”) the devil. Some scholars reject interpretation (2), because the devil was actually guilty. Therefore, even if Michael had condemned the devil, it would not have been slander against him. For example:

Michael did not dare condemn the Devil with insulting words.... (GNT) (BSB, CEV, JBP, KJV, NASB, NIV, NJB, REB, RSV, GNT)

1. It implies that the devil had committed slander (“blasphemy”), probably against Moses. Jude contrasted the fake Christians in verse 8 with the archangel Michael, not the devil. The similar passage, 2 Peter 2:11, uses the adjectival form of the word “blasphemy.” Therefore, it is more likely that 2 Peter speaks of a “blasphemous judgment,” not a “judgment for blasphemy.” If the point of comparison is similar in Jude, this favors interpretation (1) over interpretation (3). but Michael did not dare to accuse him. For example:

Michael...did not dare accuse Satan of blasphemy. (NLT) (NLT)

It is recommended that you follow interpretation (1). Michael refused to do what the fake Christians were doing (8d), that is, blaspheme against God.

against him: The phrase against him is implied information. It does not translate a particular word or phrase in the Greek text of Jude 9. If it is not necessary in your language, you do not need to make it explicit in your translation.

9d

but said, “The Lord rebuke you!”

- Instead he said, “The Lord will punish you.”^(sing)
- but said, “I ask the Lord to condemn you.”^(sing)
- Michael said, “Only the Lord may condemn you.”^(sing)

but said: The Greek words that the BSB translates as but said introduce what Michael did in contrast to what he would not do (9c). Indicate this contrast in a natural way in your language.

The Lord rebuke you!: Since only God had the authority to judge and punish the devil, Michael left it to The Lord to do it. Although the Greek expression used here is often translated as a wish or request, Jude probably used the optative to show Michael’s great respect for God. Michael does not even give the impression that he is telling the Lord what to do. It is the Lord’s prerogative alone to decide whom he will condemn and how he will punish him. Another way to translate this is: “Only **the Lord may condemn you.**” Michael did not doubt that The Lord would condemn the devil. The CEV makes it clear that Michael was sure that the Lord would do this.

All Michael said was, “The Lord will punish you!”

The Lord: Here, The Lord refers to Jesus Christ. At the time that Michael and the devil had this debate, the Christ (Messiah) was not yet incarnate.

rebuke: The Greek verb that the BSB translates as rebuke often means “reprimand.” “Reprimand” means to speak severely to someone because that person did something wrong. In this verse it seems to have a harsher meaning, such as “condemn” or “punish.” See the CEV example in the note above.

General Comment on 9a–d

In some languages, this verse will sound more natural if the order of the parts is changed. For example:

^{9a}But even the archangel Michael ^{9c}would not usurp the Lord's authority by condemning the devil. ^{9d}Instead Michael said, "The Lord will punish you." ^{9b}This happened when Michael contended with the devil and disputed with him about whether it was right for Michael to bury the body of Moses.

Jude 1:10

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians

In this section, Jude described the sins of the fake Christians in more detail. He also foretold that the Lord would punish them. He used a special Jewish style. As mentioned in the Outline, this style was called "midrash." Jewish rabbis sometimes used this text-application style of presentation in these verses. He referred to different examples, often taken from the Bible. Then he applied these examples to the situation about which he was writing.

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In this paragraph, Jude wrote that the fake Christians (verse 4) had sinned in ways which were similar to the examples of sin in verses 5–7. Jude added another example to show how evil and unwise these people were (verse 9). He then said that they were like unthinking animals (verse 10).

10

In this verse, there is a contrast between 10a and 10b–c. In the Greek text of this verse, there is a men-de relationship between 10a and 10b–c. In English, men-de is often defined as "on the one hand"... "on the other hand." None of the English versions make this explicit in their translation. This form, when used in English, usually marks some kind of contrast. In this verse, however, both the men and the de reinforce Jude's point, that is, the sinfulness of the fake Christians. The contrast relates to their response to what (men) they do not understand (10a) and to what (de) they do understand (10b–c). In both cases they act sinfully. This contrast is between the response of the fake Christians to what they did not understand and their response to what they did understand. Be sure to express this contrast clearly in your translation.

10a

These men, however, slander what they do not understand,

- But these men speak disrespectfully against those things they do not understand,
- These people, however, scorn/do-not-respect whatever and whomever they do not understand.

These men, however: The Greek pronoun that the BSB translates as These men refers here to the fake Christians whom Jude mentioned in verses 4 and 8a. This pronoun did not necessarily refer only to males. Many English versions use a more general expression. For example:

But these people... (GNT)

For another note that talks about this matter, see "certain men" in 4a.

however: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as however indicates a contrast between this verse and verse 9. In this verse, Jude contrasted the sinful ways of the fake Christians with Michael (verse 9), who respected the Lord. Jude described these people as being like unthinking animals.

slander: The Greek verb that the BSB translates here as slander is literally "blaspheme." Forms of this word were also used in 8d and 9c, where the BSB translates them as "slander" and "slandorous." Here in verse 10, the word is used in a general way. It should be translated with a general expression that could apply to either God or people. In English, "blaspheme" would generally apply to a deity, and "slander" to other personal beings, such as angels, human beings, and

possibly Jesus according to his human nature. For example:

speak against

speak disrespectfully about

slight

what they do not understand: Jude was probably not referring here to any one thing in particular that these people did not understand. English versions that support this interpretation include: BSB, GW, JBP, NASB, NIV, NJB, NRSV, REB, RSV, GNT. The people spoke against anything that they did not understand. The CEV disagrees. It seems to say that Jude was speaking specifically about the insulting of angels (see also verse 8 in the CEV, specifically 8d). Here in 10a, the CEV says: “But these people insult powers they don’t know anything about.” For example, they did not understand the Lord, the gospel message, divine authority, morality, and many other things. The fake Christians probably claimed to have special knowledge, perhaps from their dreams. Here and later in this verse, Jude disagreed with their claim to have special understanding. Ways to translate this include:

But these people abuse anything they do not understand (NJB).

But these people mock and curse the things they do not understand (NLT).

These people, however, speak disrespectfully against whatever and whomever they do not understand.

10b and like irrational animals,

- and the things they do understand by instinct, as senseless/dumb animals understand things,
- But like dumb animals, they know/understand some things that they do not have to think about.

like irrational animals: In general, animals do not reason or think about most things. They follow their natural desires. If they are hungry, they eat. If they are tired, they sleep. If it is time to mate, then they mate. Jude was implying that some of the desires that these people followed were sinful desires. They followed these desires without thinking about the

consequences of their actions. The note on 10c discusses this further.

Other ways to say this are:

like senseless animals (CEV)

like animals that do not reason

10c they will be destroyed by the things they do instinctively.

- by doing these same things they destroy themselves.
- When they do these sinful things that they do know/understand, these sinful men cause the Lord to destroy/judge them.

they will be destroyed by the things they do instinctively: Jude indicates that these fake Christians were destroying themselves by doing the things that they knew by instinct. They probably did this by following their instincts in sinful ways, such as by committing sexual sins or gluttony. By such actions, they would cause the Lord to destroy them.

they will be destroyed: There is implied information here about the way that these people would be destroyed. Their sinful actions would cause the Lord to judge and punish them. The destruction would not be only the natural results of their actions, such as troubles or disease. In some languages it may be necessary to make the Lord’s role explicit. For example:

^{10b-c}and when like animals they act on what they do understand by instinct, they cause the Lord to destroy them.

the things they do instinctively: Although there are many things that the fake Christians did not understand (10a), Jude said that they did understand some things. They understood these things instinctively. The things people do instinctively include natural urges like eating, sleeping, and having sexual relations.

instinctively: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as instinctively refers to what people naturally know to do. They understand these things, because doing them is according to their nature.

Some languages may not have a single word for instinctively. If this is true in your language, you may be able to say something like:

without thinking

according to their natural way(s)

Animals live instinctively, so Jude compared what these fake Christians do to animals, as described in the next note.

Jude 1:11

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians

In this section, Jude described the sins of the fake Christians in more detail. He also foretold that the Lord would punish them. He used a special Jewish style. As mentioned in the Outline, this style was called “midrash.” Jewish rabbis sometimes used this text-application style of presentation in these verses. He referred to different examples, often taken from the Bible. Then he applied these examples to the situation about which he was writing.

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The main purpose of the section was to show that the Lord would certainly punish these fake Christians. Jude compared them with well-known individuals and groups mentioned in the Old Testament and in other Jewish writings. He also used things found in nature to describe their sinful ways. Through these examples, he explained that these fake Christians deserved the punishment which they would receive.

Paragraph 11–13

In this paragraph, Jude compared the fake Christians to three men from the Old Testament (verse 11). These three men were Cain, Balaam, and Korah. They were famous because they had sinned greatly. Jude used these three men to show that the Lord would condemn

the fake Christians, because they had sinned like these three men had sinned. Jude also illustrated the wickedness of the fake Christians by comparing them to objects from nature (verses 12–13).

11

In this verse, Jude used a style of writing called a “woe oracle.” Woe oracles are common in the Old Testament and in the Gospels. Writers used them to announce punishment for sin, and that was Jude’s purpose here. This woe oracle has three parts. They are:

1. the woe,
2. the sins committed,
3. judgment against the fake Christians.

11a

Woe to them!

- ¶ How terrible/horrible it will be for them!
- ¶ Trouble/Punishment will surely come to them.
- ¶ They are doomed,

Woe to them!: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates here as Woe to them is often used in the Bible when people are in trouble because of their sin(s). Ways to translate this include:

How terrible it will be for them! (NLT)

They are doomed.

Trouble is coming to them.

Their sins doom them.

11b

They have traveled the path of Cain;

- They have followed the way of the evil man Cain,
- They have chosen to sin like Cain.
- because they have behaved wickedly like Adam’s son Cain did.

The Greek text of 11b begins with the conjunction, *hoti*. Here this conjunction means “because.” It introduces the reasons that the fake Christians would be judged and punished.

Many English versions, English versions that make *hoti* implicit here include: BSB, CEV, GW, NCV, NIV, NJB, REB, GNT. like the BSB, do not use a connector here. Instead, they make the connection implicit. If you translate *hoti*, try to make it clear that it connects 11a with 11b–d, not just with 11b. The NJB shows one way to translate this connection:

^{11a}Alas for them, ^{11b-d}because they have followed Cain.... (NJB)

They have traveled the path of Cain: In the Bible, words like path, “road,” or “way” often refer to the type of life that a person lives, that is, to his behavior. So They have traveled the path of Cain means:

they have chosen to behave like Cain.

In Genesis chapter 4, Cain and his brother Abel offered sacrifices to God. God accepted Abel’s sacrifice, but he did not accept Cain’s sacrifice. Because of this, Cain became very angry and murdered his brother. Although Cain’s sin of murder was emphasized, he became known more generally to the Jews as someone who was selfish and who led others to sin. Cain is mentioned in the New Testament in 1 John 3:12 as an example that we should not follow. Non-biblical Jewish literature also used Cain as an example of sinful behavior.

Jude used Cain as an example of someone who sinned throughout his life, so your translation should not be too specific. A translation should not say or imply that Jude was referring only to Cain’s murder of his brother Abel. The idea here is of a lifetime of sin. Ways to say this include:

because they behave/live wickedly like Cain did.

because they sin the way Cain did.

If the people who will read your translation do not know who Cain is, you can tell them more about him in a footnote or perhaps in a glossary.

11c

they have rushed headlong into the error of Balaam;

- they have eagerly sinned like Balaam sinned because they are greedy for money too,
- Because they are greedy for money like Balaam was, they have eagerly made the same mistake that he made.
- They have hastily made the same mistake that Balaam made of leading other people to sin in order to make money.

they have rushed headlong: The fake Christians were eager to get what they wanted, and this made them very willing to sin. Several English versions use rushed to describe the complete willingness of these fake Christians to sin in order to get what they wanted

(BSB, GW, JBP, NASB, NIV). In fact, the Greek expression literally indicates that they were “carried along” by the sin. This is a figure of speech, and in some languages there may be other figures to express this idea. Other ways to express it in English include:

they have plunged into (REB)

abandon themselves to (NRSV)

they have given themselves (NCV, GNT)

If your language has a special way to speak about a person who does something without hesitation and without holding himself back, you may want to use it here.

into the error of Balaam: Balaam was a prophet. Balaam is identified as a prophet in 2 Peter 2:15–16, who lived during the time of Moses (Numbers 22–24 and Deuteronomy 23:3–6). He was not an Israelite. The leaders of Moab and Midian, according to Numbers 22:7, the elders of Moab and the elders of Midian went to Balaam, who were enemies of the Israelites, hired Balaam to curse the Israelites.

God did not allow Balaam to curse the Israelites, so the leaders did not pay Balaam. Because he wanted money, Balaam made a new plan. He told the enemies of the Israelites to send their women to seduce the Israelite men to sin sexually and worship idols (Numbers chapter 25 and Numbers 31:16). Many Israelite men sinned with these women. Later, the Israelites killed Balaam (Numbers 31:8).

error: Balaam’s greed caused his error. His error was sinful, not an error that he made by accident. His error has two main aspects:

1. His error was the wrong he did, that he led others to sin. For example:

for money they have given themselves to doing the wrong that Balaam did. (NCV)

1. His error was his wrong thinking. His desire for money led him to make the mistake of going against God. He paid a big price for this mistake—death (Numbers 31:8). For example:

they have thrown themselves into the same delusion as Balaam for a reward. (NJB)

The fake Christians erred just like Balaam had erred.

One way to translate 11c that includes both aspects is:

They have wholeheartedly given themselves over to sin. Because they are greedy for money like Balaam was, they have made the mistake that he made of leading other people to sin.

11d
they have perished in Korah’s rebellion.

- and they will surely be ruined/destroyed because they are rebelling like Korah did.
- And because they lead people to rebel against God as Korah did, they have ruined/destroyed themselves.
- Just like Korah was destroyed because of his rebellion, these people will be destroyed because they also are rebelling against the Lord.

they have perished: The BSB has used a passive verb here. However, the Greek text could also be translated literally as “they have destroyed themselves.” By their rebellion, the fake Christians caused their own destruction. Other ways to say this are:

they have...destroyed themselves (GW, JBP)

they have been ruined by the same rebellion as Korah—and share the same fate. (NJB)

The Lord is the one who would punish the fake Christians, but this verse focuses on their sinful actions. However, in some languages it may be more natural to use a passive verb. For translators working in a language that does not use passive verbs, it is especially appropriate to use a reflexive translation like “they have destroyed themselves.” Such a translation would not require a translator to specify “the Lord” or “God” as an agent, thus shifting the focus of the verse away from the motivation and actions of the fake Christians. None of the English versions used in these Notes have changed the expression to an active one in such a way. For example:

they will...be destroyed (CEV, NCV)

they will...perish (NET, NLT)

have perished: Jude spoke here as though they had already been destroyed or perished. However, he did not mean that the fake Christians had already been punished or had died. Instead, the verb form he used indicates that they had made their destruction

certainThe thought is similar to the English idiomatic expression, “They are as good as dead.” by disobeying God. In some languages it may be more natural to use a future tense. For example:

And like Korah, they will perish because of their rebellion. (NLT)

in Korah’s rebellion: Korah, along with some other Israelite men, led a rebellion against Moses and Aaron (Numbers chapter 16). By rebelling against the leaders whom God had chosen, Korah and his followers were rebelling against God himself. God gave just Aaron and his sons the privilege of being priests, and God assigned just the Levites to serve in his house. Korah and his followers rebelled, by saying that Israelites from other tribes and families could also do these things. God destroyed the leaders of this rebellion by causing the earth to open up and “swallow” them alive. He also sent fire from heaven to destroy the people who followed Korah and the other leaders.

rebellion: The Greek word that the BSB translates as rebellion does not refer to an armed or military conflict. Instead, it refers to disobedience. Korah disobeyed the Lord and also led other people to disobey him. The fake Christians that Jude wrote about also disobeyed the Lord and influenced others to disobey him.

Jude 1:12

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians

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12–13

In these two verses, Jude illustrated the wickedness of the fake Christians by comparing them to objects from nature.

12a

These men are hidden reefs in your love feasts,

- These people are like dangerous rocks hidden under the water, as they are with you^(plur) at your fellowship meals.
- Just as hidden rocks in the water/sea are dangerous to boats, these people are dangerous to you^(plur) at the special meals you^(plur) share as believers.
- They are a danger/hazard to you^(plur) when you meet for your^(plur) fellowship meals.

These men: Jude referred here to the same fake Christians whom he mentioned in verses 4, 8a, and 10–11. The Greek pronoun that the BSB translates here as These men did not necessarily refer only to males. Many English versions use a more general expression. For example:

These people... (REB)

They... (NCV)

Other notes that discuss this matter are “certain men” in 4a and “these men” in 10a.

are hidden reefs: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as hidden reefs is used here as a figure of speech. Scholars have interpreted the word in two different ways in this context:

1. It means dangerous rocks or reefs. Jude compared the fake Christians to rocks or reefs hidden in the water that are dangerous to ships that might come too close and hit them. For example:

These men are dangerous reefs at your love feasts. (NET) (BSB, JBP, NASB, NET, NJB, NLT, REB)

1. It refers to dirty spots or stains. Jude indicated that the behavior of the fake Christians at the love feasts disgraced or dishonored the true Christians. For example:

With their shameless carousing they are like dirty spots in your fellowship meals. (GNT) (CEV, GW, KJV, NCV, NIV, NRSV, RSV, GNT)

Both interpretations are possible. You may want to use the same interpretation that the Bible of the major language in your area uses. It is recommended that you place the other interpretation in a footnote.

hidden reefs: In some cultures, where people live far from the sea, they may not understand clearly how rocks in the sea would be dangerous. If this illustration would not be clear to your readers, here are other options:

- Use a different figure of speech that readers in your culture will understand to mean dangerous.
- Translate without using a figure of speech. For example:

They are a dangerous hazard. (NJB)

love feasts: Early in the history of the church, Christians gathered together often and had a meal. At these meals they celebrated the Lord's Supper. Some passages in the New Testament that speak about the Lord's Supper are: Matthew 26:26–30, Mark 14:22–26, Luke 22:19–20, I Corinthians 10:15–16, I Corinthians 11:23–26. (sometimes referred to as the Eucharist or Communion). They called these meals love feasts. Other ways to say this include:

fellowship meals (NLT, GNT)

special Christian meals you share (NCV)

See love, Meaning 2, in the Glossary.

12b

shamelessly feasting with you

- When they eat with you,^(plur) they are bold and do not feel ashamed.
- Even though they act shamefully at these meals, they do not feel afraid or ashamed of their shameful actions.

shamelessly feasting with you: This refers to the attitude of the fake Christians. In this context, the Greek word that the BSB translates as shamelessly expresses two aspects of their attitude:

1. They were not ashamed, even though they should have felt ashamed.
2. They were without fear. They were bold, even though they should have felt afraid.

Scholars have different opinions about how this Greek word relates to the other parts of this verse. There are two possibilities:

1. It is connected to the first part of 12b, feasting with you. For example:

They eat with you and don't feel ashamed. (GW)

they eat in your company without a qualm. (JBP)
(BSB, GW, JBP, NASB, NCV, NET, NIV, NRSV, REB, GNT)

1. It is connected to 12c, "shepherds who are shepherding only themselves." For example:

^{12b}...and quite shamelessly ^{12c} only looking after themselves. (NJB) (KJV, NJB, NLT)

It is recommended that you follow interpretation (1), as most English versions do. The fake Christians behaved badly at the fellowship meals. They should have felt ashamed of how they acted, but they did not feel ashamed. Their behavior showed that they did not respect the love feasts as a time of fellowship. It also showed that they did not respect the real Christians with whom they ate, or God.

12c

but shepherding only themselves.

- They are like shepherds who only feed themselves but neglect their sheep.

- They are like shepherds who only take care of themselves; they do not help other people.
- They care for no one but themselves, like shepherds who only benefit themselves and do not tend the sheep.

but shepherding only themselves: Leaders of the Christian church were often called "shepherds." Jude implied that the fake Christians were leaders in the church to which Jude wrote. Instead of shepherding the real believers by teaching them the truth from God's word, they were only interested in gaining benefit for themselves. This description of the fake Christians is similar to Ezekiel 34:2 where God said:

Disaster is in store for the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves! Are not shepherds meant to feed a flock? (NJB)

"Shepherds" is a figure of speech that is commonly used in the Bible, so you will want to use it in your translation. In this context it is used as a metaphor. You may need to look for ways to make this metaphor clearer in your language: Here are some possibilities:

- Keep the shepherd metaphor, but use a verb like "look after" or "take care of," instead of shepherding. For example:

They are shepherds who only take care only of themselves. (REB)

- Use a simile instead of a metaphor. For example:

They are like shepherds who only take care of themselves.

- Add implied information to indicate the specific way in which these people were like the selfish shepherds. For example:

Like shepherds who only feed themselves but do not feed their sheep, these people only help themselves, not other people.

12d

They are clouds without water, carried along by the wind;

- They are useless, like clouds that do not produce rain because the wind blows them past/away.
- They are like clouds that the wind blows over dry/thirsty land without giving any rain. They promise much, but give nothing.

clouds without water, carried along by the wind:

The area of the world in which Jude's readers lived was dry. People needed rain to grow food and to have water for them and their animals to drink. Sometimes clouds appeared, but no rain fell. The wind blew the clouds along quickly, and they passed over without any rain falling. Such clouds were useless and disappointing. Proverbs 25:14 says, "Like clouds and wind without rain is a man who boasts of gifts he does not give" (NIV).

These fake Christians also were useless and disappointing. Jude compared them to clouds without water, because they did nothing to help the real Christians to whom Jude wrote.

In some languages this figure of speech may not express this meaning. In that case, it may be necessary to indicate the meaning by adding implied information. For example:

They are like clouds which the wind blows over dry land without rain falling. They promise much but produce/give nothing.

12e**fruitless trees in autumn, twice dead after being uprooted.**

- They are like trees at harvest time that have no fruit. Like trees that have been uprooted, they are completely dead.
- They are as useless as fruit trees that have no fruit at harvest time. Like uprooted fruit trees they cannot produce/do anything good.

fruitless trees in autumn: The Greek word that the BSB translates as autumn probably referred to late autumn. This is the only place that this Greek word is found in the New Testament. This is the time of year when trees would be expected to have fruit ready to pick. There is another way to interpret this metaphor: Late autumn was after the harvest was over, and the trees had lost their leaves. A tree like that cannot have "fruit." Therefore, according to this interpretation, the meaning of this expression is "trees that can have no 'fruit' because harvest time is over." Like "fruit trees" cannot have "fruit" after the harvest is over and their leaves have fallen off, these fake Christians cannot do anything good. Some English versions have translated according to this interpretation without mentioning late autumn. Instead they mention the condition of the "trees" at that time. For example: They are like leafless trees...unable to produce fruit (CEV).-or-they are withered...without any fruit (GW).

The meaning of 12e is almost the same as 12d. In both metaphors, Jude illustrated how useless and unhelpful these people were. They are like fruit trees that should have fruit, but have none. Some ways to say this are:

They are like trees that bear no fruit, even in autumn. (GNT)

They are like fruit trees that have no fruit even at harvest time.

twice dead: Jude described these people as trees that are twice dead. The phrase twice dead meant that they were completely dead. They were useless, totally incapable of producing anything good. Two other interpretations of twice dead are: (1) They were spiritually dead because of their moral corruption, and were already marked/destined to receive the second death on Judgment Day. The phrase twice dead with this interpretation is similar in meaning to "they have been destroyed" in 11d. (2) They were dead in sin prior to conversion, then were brought to life through conversion and baptism, and now were dead a second time because they had become apostates. Other ways to say this include:

completely dead (GNT)

doubly dead (JBP, NASB)

not only dead but doubly dead. (NLT)

after being uprooted: Jude used the metaphor of uprooted trees to illustrate how completely unable the fake Christians were to do good. They were as useless as uprooted trees that can never give fruit. They could not do anything good to please God or help his people. Some scholars interpret uprooted here to mean that God would destroy these people, like a farmer would uproot a fruit tree that never bears fruit. However, Jude did not make this meaning explicit, and there are other reasonable interpretations. It is recommended that you do not follow the interpretation that uprooted means that God would destroy these fake Christians.

Jude 1:13

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians

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13

In 12d–e, Jude described these fake Christians as useless. Here in verse 13, he used illustrations to show that they were worse than just useless, they were harmful.

13a

They are wild waves of the sea,

- They are like rough/wild ocean waves
- These people are out of control. Like foaming ocean waves,
- Like rough/wild waves of the sea

wild waves of the sea: Jude further described the fake Christians with the metaphor of wild waves in the sea. Like wild waves, they lived in an uncontrolled manner. They acted without concern for what is right.

In some languages this metaphor may not express the meaning clearly. If that is true in your language, here are other options:

- Use a simile. For example:

They are like wild waves of the sea. (NLT)

- Make explicit the similarity between the wild waves and these people. Some other ways to state how the fake Christians are similar to wild waves are: They act/behave wildly. -or- They are out of control. For example:

They are without control, like wild waves of the sea.

13b

foaming up their own shame;

- that throw out foam; they foam with shameful actions.
- they wildly spew out disgraceful deeds.
- produce dirty foam, these people produce/do shameful things.

foaming up their own shame: Here Jude continued the metaphor that he used in 13a. Just as waves of the sea produce dirty foam, so these fake Christians Jude may have had either of two pictures in his mind. (1) The foam produced by the waves remained on the surface of the sea. (2) The waves deposited the dirty foam on the beach. Either of these options may be correct. However, it is recommended that you follow the example of the English versions and not mention a “beach” or “the shore.” produce shameful actions.

If this metaphor is not clear, you may translate it as a simile. For example:

and like such waves produce dirty foam, what they do/produce is shameful.

General Comment on 13a–b

The metaphor that Jude used here is similar to the one in Isaiah 57:20: “the tossing sea...whose waves cast up mire and mud.”

If the sea and waves are unfamiliar to your readers, you may be able to state the meaning plainly, without the figure of “wild foaming waves.” For example:

^{13a}They are wild, not caring about what is right.

^{13b}Their actions are disgusting!

^{13a}Their uncontrolled actions ^{13b}are shameful.

13c wandering stars,

- They are like certain stars that wander about in the sky.
- They are unfit guides, like some stars which do not travel a regular/predictable course/path.
- They are like certain stars that are useless to navigate by at night, because they move unpredictably. You^(plur) should not follow these people.

wandering stars: In past times, many people used the stars to determine their direction at night. It is likely that the wandering stars that Jude used in this metaphor were the planets. Compared to other stars, the planets seemed to wander across the sky, and so they were unreliable guides for navigation. If Jude’s readers understood the wandering stars to be the planets, they might also have seen a comparison to the Roman and Greek gods who shared names with the planets. Whole societies had been misled by believing in these false gods. They could do this because stars moved in a way that they could predict. The Greek expression that the BSB translates as wandering stars refers to other lights in the sky. Some scholars believe that this refers to the planets. Compared to the stars, these lights seemed to wander across the sky. This made them useless for indicating direction.

The fake Christians misled people. Like the wandering stars, they were not reliable as guides, and people should not follow (imitate) them.

If this metaphor is not clear, you may use a simile. You may also make explicit the similarity between the wandering stars and the fake Christians. For example:

They are unfit guides, like stars that wander unpredictably in the sky.

13d for whom blackest darkness has been reserved forever.

- A place of deep darkness is waiting/reserved for them, where they must stay forever.
- The Lord is keeping a place for them that is completely dark where they must stay forever.
- The Lord intends to confine them in the complete darkness of hell for eternity.

In this part of the verse Jude indicated that the Lord was keeping a place of eternal darkness for the fake Christians. They would be sent there because they did not really believe in Jesus, and when they joined the church, they planned to do evil. This eternal darkness is one description of the place of eternal punishment, which other biblical writers have called “hell.”

for whom blackest darkness has been reserved forever: Here Jude used irony to emphasize the punishment of the fake Christians. In 13c, he used the metaphor of “wandering stars.” The irony is that though Jude described the fake Christians as lights in the sky, they would have to stay in the blackest darkness forever.

for whom: The Greek pronoun that the BSB translates here as for whom can refer to either the fake Christians or the wandering stars. Either way, Jude was referring to the fake Christians, because the stars were a metaphor that he had used to describe them.

blackest darkness: The Bible sometimes refers to the place of eternal punishment as darkness (for example, Matthew 8:12, 22:13, 25:30). The Greek word that the BSB translates as blackest is the same word that the BSB translates as darkness in 6c. It can also be translated as “gloom.” Other ways to translate this include:

the utter depths of...darkness (NET)

the deepest darkness (NRSV, GNT)

gloomy darkness (GW)

has been reserved: Jude frequently used the Greek verb, *tēreō*, which the BSB has translated as “kept” or “stay.” He used a form of *tēreō* in 1f, 6a, 6c, here in 13d (where the BSB uses the verb “reserved”), and “kept” in 21a. Though it was possible for Jude to use one verb in all these places, the meanings translated into natural English require the use of more than one English verb. If it is more natural in your language to use active verbs, you may need to say who it was who

reserved the darkness. The NLT makes the verb active without saying who reserved the darkness. The NLT did this by referring to the darkness as the destination that the fake Christians were “heading” for, rather than as something waiting for them. It says: “They are...heading for everlasting gloom and darkness.” For example:

The Lord has reserved a place for them....

forever: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates here as forever can be translated literally as “for eternity.” Jude meant that the fake Christians would have to stay in the darkness forever.

Jude 1:14

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians

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Paragraph 14–16

In this paragraph, Jude quoted a prophecy made by a man named Enoch. Enoch lived in the Old Testament period, before the great flood. Genesis 5:18–24 indicates that Enoch had a special relationship with God, and that he never died.

Enoch prophesied that the Lord would condemn people like these fake Christians. Jude did not learn this prophecy from the Bible, but from some other reliable source.

Jude presented the information about Enoch in an order that is unusual for some languages, including English. A general comment at the end of the notes for 15d shows a way to reorder 14–15.

14a

Enoch, the seventh from Adam,

- ¶ Enoch was the seventh generation from Adam, who was the first.
- ¶ Enoch was born in the seventh generation starting with Adam, who was born in the first generation.

Enoch, the seventh from Adam: Jude identified Enoch as the seventh from Adam. The list of his ancestors recorded in Genesis chapter 5 begins with Adam, the first person whom God created. The order in Genesis 5 is:

1. Adam
2. Seth
3. Enosh
4. Kenan
5. Mahalalel
6. Jared
7. Enoch

According to the way that Jude and his readers counted generations, Enoch was the seventh from Adam. They counted Adam as the first generation. According to the way that some other people groups normally count generations today, Enoch was the sixth generation from Adam.

Because the number seven is an important number in the Bible, the number seven can symbolize completeness. It is recommended that you use seventh in your translation, instead of “sixth.” You may be able to say something like:

Enoch was the seventh generation from Adam, who was the first.

If your language requires you to say something other than seventh, it is recommended that you include

a footnote explaining that Jude wrote seventh. For example:

This numbering includes both the first and the last in the series of seven names from Adam to Enoch. (GNT)

14b

also prophesied about them:

- Enoch prophesied about these people when he said,
- God inspired him to predict what would happen to people like these. He said,

prophesied: Enoch’s prophecy is not recorded in the Old Testament. However, a similar statement was written in the non-biblical Jewish book of 1 Enoch. The Greek word that the BSB translates as prophesied can also be translated as:

foretold

told what would happen

was inspired by God to foretell...

See prophecy in the Glossary.

about them: The Greek pronoun *toutois* is in the dative case. In a note, the NET interprets this as a dative of disadvantage, meaning that Enoch prophesied “against them.” The Greek expression that the BSB translates as about them can also be translated as:

about these men (NIV)

about these people (CEV)

against them (REB)

them: The Greek pronoun that the BSB translates here as them refers to the fake Christians whom Jude mentioned in verses 4, 8, and 10–13. Some English versions use a general expression like “these people.” Other notes that refer to this issue are “certain men” in 4a, and “these men” in 12a and in 10a.

General Comment on 14 a-b

The third word in the Greek text of Jude 14 is *kai*, which is often translated “and.” Here it probably means “also” as in 14b of the BSB and indicates that the fake Christians were also included in what Enoch

prophesied. Consider a natural way in your language to express this. For example:

It was of these also that Enoch in the seventh generation from Adam prophesied. (RSV)

In some languages, it may be more natural to leave this *kai* untranslated.

14c

“Behold, the Lord is coming with myriads of His holy ones

- “Look!^(plur) The Lord will certainly come with many thousands of his holy angels.
- “Listen!^(plur) to this! The Lord will certainly come with a very large number of his holy angels.

The Greek text of this verse contains the verb *legōn*, which can be translated literally as “saying.” For example:

It was of these also that Enoch...prophesied, saying, (RSV)

This verb introduces Enoch’s prophecy. In 14c through the end of 15, Jude quoted Enoch’s words. Introduce this quote in a natural way in your language.

Behold: The Greek word *idou* that the BSB translates as Behold is used here to focus the attention of the reader on what Jude was about to say. Other ways to translate this word include:

Look!

Listen to this!

I tell you

Consider how to focus the readers’ attention in a natural way in your language. If your language would not use an expression like *idou* here, you may need to omit it, as some English versions have done. For example:

The Lord will come with many thousands of his holy angels... (GNT)

the Lord: The phrase the Lord refers here to Jesus Christ. Jude referred to him as Lord in this verse, even though Lord was not in Enoch’s original prophecy.¹ Enoch 1:9 says, “And behold! He cometh with ten thousands of His holy ones...” (R.H. Charles, *The Apocrypha*

and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament in English (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1973, 1913), page 189.

is coming: The form of the Greek verb that the BSB translates here as is coming is past tense (“came”). Enoch’s prophecy concerned future events. However, Jude quoted Enoch as if he were speaking about past events. The past tense may indicate that the prophet had actually seen the events of the prophecy in a vision or in his mind. For example, the REB says: “I saw the Lord come with his myriads of angels....” It was common for prophets to speak like this to indicate that the prophecy would certainly happen. Another way to think about this certainty is that, by using the past tense, the prophet indicated that what he prophesied was as certain as if it had already happened.

You may use the verb form that is most appropriate in your language to communicate a prophecy (whether past, present, future, or another form). In some languages it will be helpful to include a word like “certainly” to emphasize that the prophecy was certain to happen. For example,

The Lord will certainly come...

myriads: The Greek word that the BSB translates as myriads is the plural form of “ten thousand.” The word is used in a general way to mean “a very large number.” It does not refer to any precise number. Ways to translate this include:

many thousands

countless

very many

of His holy ones: Most scholars think that His holy ones refers to his angels. See angel, Meaning 1, and holy, Meaning 2, in the Glossary. You may use your key term for angels here. For example:

of his angels

of his holy angels

Jude 1:15

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians
In this section, Jude described the sins of the fake Christians in more detail. He also foretold that the

Lord would punish them. He used a special Jewish style. As mentioned in the Outline, this style was called “midrash.” Jewish rabbis sometimes used this text-application style of presentation in these verses. He referred to different examples, often taken from the Bible. Then he applied these examples to the situation about which he was writing.

Jude organized this part of his letter as follows:

Example	Application
verses 5–7	verse 8 Verse 8 is the application for the examples in 5–7 and could end that paragraph. Verse 8 also introduces 9–10 and could begin that paragraph. These Notes show the paragraph division between verse 7 and verse 8, as does almost every English version.
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The main purpose of the section was to show that the Lord would certainly punish these fake Christians. Jude compared them with well-known individuals and groups mentioned in the Old Testament and in other Jewish writings. He also used things found in nature to describe their sinful ways. Through these examples, he explained that these fake Christians deserved the punishment which they would receive.

Paragraph 14–16

In this paragraph, Jude quoted a prophecy made by a man named Enoch. Enoch lived in the Old Testament period, before the great flood. Genesis 5:18–24 indicates that Enoch had a special relationship with God, and that he never died.

Enoch prophesied that the Lord would condemn people like these fake Christians. Jude did not learn this prophecy from the Bible, but from some other reliable source.

Jude presented the information about Enoch in an order that is unusual for some languages, including English. A general comment at the end of the notes for 15d shows a way to reorder 14–15.

15

In this verse, Jude continued to quote a prophecy made by Enoch. This quotation started at 14c and ends at 15d.

This verse repeats the word for “ungodly” several times for emphasis. See the general comment at the end of the notes for 15d for translation suggestions.

15a

to execute judgment on everyone,

- He will come to judge everyone,
- When he comes, he will judge all people,

to execute judgment on everyone: The prophecy indicates here that the Lord will execute judgment on everyone when he returns. However, he will “convict” (15b) only the “ungodly” people (15b–d).

to execute judgment: In this context, the Greek phrase that the BSB translates here as to execute judgment means “to say publicly whether someone is guilty or not guilty.” It does not include the idea of deciding punishment. Here are some other ways to translate the word execute:

declare

pronounce/announce

proclaim

everyone: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as everyone is literally “all.” It refers to all human beings. This includes both righteous people and unrighteous people.

15b

and to convict all the ungodly

- and to condemn all the impious people
- and he will convict all of those who did not respect him
- and he will declare guilty everyone who did not accept his authority

and to convict: In this context, the Greek verb that the BSB translates as to convict means “to declare someone to be guilty and to sentence the guilty person to be punished.” Some other ways that English versions translate this include:

to sentence (NJB)

to condemn (GNT)

to punish (NCV)

all the ungodly: Copies of the Greek text differ about the phrase that is used here:

1. Some copies have a phrase that means all the ungodly. Most English versions follow these copies. (Some of these versions leave the idea all implicit.) For example:

all the godless (REB)

all the ungodly (NASB) (BSB, CEV, GW, JBP, KJV, NASB, NIV, NJB, NLT, REB, RSV, NCV)

1. Some other copies have a phrase that means “every soul.” Some English versions follow these copies. For example:

every person (NET) (NET, NRSV, GNT)

It is recommended that you follow option (1).

ungodly: The Greek word asebeias, which the BSB translates here as ungodly, is the same word that was used in 4c. This Greek adjective described people who did not respect God or his authority. Because they did not respect God’s authority over them, they lived sinful lives. Ways to translate this include: Although the word “ungodly” includes the English word for God, this is not true in Greek (The Greek word is asebeis.) It is not necessary in other languages to include a word for “god” in the expression that is used to translate this idea. Some examples of ways to translate without using a word for god are: “impious,” “irreverent,” “immoral,” or “irreligious.”

impious

irreverent

do not respect God

In English an adjective like ungodly implies a noun like “people.” In some languages it may be necessary to include a word to clarify what ungodly describes. For example:

ungodly people (CEV)

ungodly sinners (GW)

Jude used other forms of this Greek word several times in this verse, and once in 18d.

15c

of every ungodly act of wickedness

- for all the immoral acts they have disrespectfully done,
- for all the immoral and evil things that they have done,
- because of all of their evil actions,

of every ungodly act of wickedness: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates as of every ungodly act of wickedness can also be translated literally as “concerning all of the/their ungodly works.” These ungodly works are everything that they have done to disobey or disrespect God.

Again, Jude used another form of the Greek word that the BSB translates as ungodly in 15b. These people did not just disobey and disrespect God, but they did it in ways that showed their disrespect of him. Some ways to say this include:

they have done in rebellion (NLT)

which they have committed in an ungodly manner

15d

and every harsh word spoken against Him by ungodly sinners.”

- and for all the defiant words that they have disrespectfully spoken against him.”
- and because of all the insulting/hurtful words that sinful people have spoken against him.”

Enoch had prophesied that the Lord would convict ungodly people also for the harsh words they spoke against him. Jude had already stated that Enoch’s prophecy applied to the fake Christians that he wrote about in this letter (14b). Jude had already mentioned that these fake Christians were guilty of disrespectful speech against the Lord Jesus (8d, 10a).

and every harsh word: The Greek term that the BSB translates here as harsh word refers to talk which is disrespectful, defiant, insulting, or hurtful.

spoken against Him: This phrase refers specifically to the words they have spoken against the Lord. Enoch indicated that sinners would be punished for what they said against the Lord, not only for what they did (15c).

Him: The Greek pronoun that the BSB translates here as Him refers to the Lord. This pronoun refers back to “the Lord” in 14c.

by ungodly sinners: The Greek adjective that the BSB translates here as sinners can also be translated literally as “sinful.” Here Jude added sinful to his description of the ungodly people. This emphasized that they were guilty and deserved to be punished.

In some languages the words ungodly and sinners may be too similar to translate separately. If that is true in your language, you may need to use only one term here instead of two.

ungodly: Here Jude again used another form of the Greek word which the BSB translates as ungodly in 15b.

General Comment on 15a–d

In this verse, Jude repeated the Greek word that the BSB translates as “ungodly” several times. He also used the word “sinners.” He did this to emphasize that the fake Christians were very guilty, and they deserved for the Lord to punish them. Repetition is a natural way to express this emphasis in Greek.

In some languages it may not be natural to repeat a word so many times in such a short verse. If this is true in your language, look for the most natural way to emphasize their guilt. You may be able to do this by using several different words to express the idea. For example:

to convict all ungodly people for all the immoral and evil things that they have done, and for all the harsh words sinners have spoken against him.

He will sentence/condemn all ungodly people for all of their evil and impious actions, and for everything disrespectful that immoral and sinful people have spoken against him.

General Comment on 14–15

The BSB text of 14a–b has reordered the phrases to be more natural English. In the Greek text, Jude began the verse by referring to the fake Christians as the ones whom Enoch prophesied about. The RSV follows the Greek order more closely here. For example:

^{14b}It was of these also that ^{14a}Enoch in the seventh generation from Adam ^{14b}prophesied, saying... (RSV)

In some languages it may not be natural or possible to introduce the information in that order. It may help to reorder verses 14–15. Reordering may also help to connect these verses to verse 16. For example:

^{14a} Enoch, born in the seventh generation from Adam, ^{14b}prophesied, ^{14c}“See, the Lord will certainly come with many thousands of his holy angels. ^{15a}When he comes, he will judge everyone, ^{15b}and he will sentence all ungodly people. ^{15c}He will condemn them for all the immoral and evil things they have done, ^{15d}and for everything disrespectful that ungodly and sinful people have spoken against him.” ^{14b}Enoch’s prophecy applies also to the people who have infiltrated your church. ^{16a}These men are...

If you use this order, you may need to use a more specific phrase at the end of 14-15 to refer to the fake Christians. Since “These men” in 16a resumes the description of the fake Christians, it may be helpful at the end of 14-15 to use a clear phrase in your language. You can consider using the one which you used in 4c. In the example above, these people are referred to as “the people who have infiltrated your church.”

Jude 1:16

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians
In this section, Jude described the sins of the fake Christians in more detail. He also foretold that the Lord would punish them. He used a special Jewish styleAs mentioned in the Outline, this style was called “midrash.” Jewish rabbis sometimes used this text-application style of presentation. in these verses. He referred to different examples, often taken from the Bible. Then he applied these examples to the situation about which he was writing.

Jude organized this part of his letter as follows:

Example	Application
verses 5–7	verse 8Verse 8 is the application for the examples in 5–7 and could end that paragraph. Verse 8 also introduces 9–10 and could begin that paragraph. These Notes show the paragraph division between verse 7 and verse 8, as does almost every English version.
verse 9	verse 10
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verses 14–15	verse 16
verses 17–18	verse 19

The main purpose of the section was to show that the Lord would certainly punish these fake Christians. Jude compared them with well-known individuals and groups mentioned in the Old Testament and in other Jewish writings. He also used things found in nature to describe their sinful ways. Through these examples, he explained that these fake Christians deserved the punishment which they would receive.

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In this paragraph, Jude quoted a prophecy made by a man named Enoch. Enoch lived in the Old Testament period, before the great flood. Genesis 5:18–24 indicates that Enoch had a special relationship with God, and that he never died.

Enoch prophesied that the Lord would condemn people like these fake Christians. Jude did not learn this prophecy from the Bible, but from some other reliable source.

Jude presented the information about Enoch in an order that is unusual for some languages, including English. A general comment at the end of the notes for 15d shows a way to reorder 14–15.

16

In this verse, Jude applied Enoch’s prophecy (14c and 15a–d) directly to the fake Christians in the Christian church to which he was writing.As mentioned in the Introduction for these Notes, Jude used the “midrash” style, which was sometimes used by Jewish rabbis. This style had text-application pairs. Here Jude wrote the application part (verse 16) of this midrash (14–16). This comment applied the text part (14c–15) to the situation about which Jude was writing. In 16 he further described the ways of the fake Christians.

16a

These men are discontented grumblers,

- These men grumble and complain continually,
- These people about whom I am writing to you^(plur) always complain and blame the Lord.

These men: Again, These men refers to the fake Christians. Jude mentioned these people frequently throughout his letter (4, 8a, 10–13, 14b).

men: The Greek pronoun that the BSB translates as “These men” did not necessarily refer only to males. Many English versions do not indicate whether they were male or female. For example:

These people... (GNT)

They... (REB)

discontented: The Greek word that the BSB translates as discontented refers to people who are critical and find fault with others. They criticize other people, the Lord, The fake Christians may have been blaming the Lord for the things they did not like. situations, or anything at all. This word is similar in meaning to the word that the BSB translates as “grumblers,” and the form also implies that the fake Christians did this repeatedly or as a habit. Some ways to translate this idea are:

faultfinders (NIV)

blame others (NCV)

criticizers

malcontents

In some languages it may be necessary to specify with whom they found fault. If that is true in your language, you may specify that they found fault with the Lord. However, it is better to be general here, if possible.

grumblers: The Greek word that the BSB translates as grumblers refers to people who complain. Some English versions use a verb to translate this idea. For example:

These people grumble. (CEV)

These people complain. (NCV)

The Greek word indicates that the people grumbled as a habit. They complained repeatedly. If your language has a special way to indicate habitual or repeated action, consider using it here.

Jude did not say against whom the fake Christians were grumbling or what they were grumbling about. However, in the context, he may be referring to the “harsh words” they “spoke against” the Lord (verse 15). Specifically, the Lord Jesus Christ. In a sense, all grumbling is against the Lord, because he is ruler over everything.

In this letter, whenever Jude specified the person against whom a particular sin was directed, it was

always against the Lord. In verse 4, the fake Christians rejected the Lord, and in verse 5, the Israelites did not trust him. Here in verse 16 Jude was commenting on verses 14–15, where Enoch’s prophecy said that the Lord would declare guilty people who spoke harsh words against him. Therefore, it is reasonable to think that the fake Christians whom Jude described in verse 16 were grumbling against the Lord. In some languages it may be necessary to make “the Lord” explicit here.

16b

following after their own lusts;

- they use only their own desires to decide what they will do.
- and they do the evil acts they desire to do.
- Their own desires lead them to sin.

following after their own lusts: This English phrase is a figure of speech. The Greek text says literally: “proceeding/going according to their desires.” It indicates that their desires were the basis for their actions. They used their own desires to decide what to do, instead of considering the Lord’s will. Here is another way to translate this phrase:

follow their own desires (GW)

lusts: The Greek word that the BSB translates as lusts is neutral. It can refer to good desires as well as to evil ones, depending on the context. The text implies that these people followed their own desires instead of what the Lord desired. However, in this context, their desires were evil. Some ways to translate this include:

They do the evil acts they desire to do.

Their own evil desires lead/entice them to sin.

governed only by their own desires (NJB)

who go wherever their desires lead them (NET)

16c

their mouths spew arrogance;

- They brag about how great they are,
- They make boastful claims about themselves,
- With their mouths they boast,

their mouths spew arrogance: The Greek text that the BSB translates as their mouths spew arrogance is literally “and the mouths of them speaking too-large.” The fake Christians were saying arrogant things. In the

context, Jude may be referring to their arrogant claims that showed their disrespect for the Lord’s authority. Some ways to translate this are:

- say arrogant things (GW)
- with mouths full of boastful talk (NJB)
- They brag about themselves. (CEV, NCV, GNT)

Look for the most natural way in your language to clearly communicate this idea.

16d
they flatter others for their own advantage.

- and they flatter other people for their own benefit.
- and they compliment other people so that they themselves may benefit.
- and they pretend to admire other people in order to get what they want.

flatter others for their own advantage: Jude indicated here that they complimented other people and pretended to admire them, even if they did not deserve it. They did this to get what they wanted, not to express sincere appreciation. Other ways to translate this include:

- flatter others to get what they want (CEV, NCV)
- compliment other people for their own benefit

Jude 1:17

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians

In this section, Jude described the sins of the fake Christians in more detail. He also foretold that the Lord would punish them. He used a special Jewish styleAs mentioned in the Outline, this style was called “midrash.” Jewish rabbis sometimes used this text-application style of presentation. in these verses. He referred to different examples, often taken from the Bible. Then he applied these examples to the situation about which he was writing.

Jude organized this part of his letter as follows:

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The main purpose of the section was to show that the Lord would certainly punish these fake Christians. Jude compared them with well-known individuals and groups mentioned in the Old Testament and in other Jewish writings. He also used things found in nature to describe their sinful ways. Through these examples, he explained that these fake Christians deserved the punishment which they would receive.

Paragraph 17–19

In this paragraph, Jude used the text-application styleThe style he used was the “midrash” style, which was sometimes used by Jewish rabbis (see the Introduction for these Notes). This midrash has a text-application pair. The text (18b–d) was a prophecy taught by the apostles of Jesus Christ. In verse 19, Jude applied this prophecy to the situation that Jude’s readers faced. again for the last time in his letter.This is the last midrash of the letter. (See Section 5–19 for more explanation of this style.) In verses 17–18 he reminded his readers of a prophecy which the apostles of Jesus Christ had made. They had prophesied that there would be scoffers who would follow their own evil desires. In verse 19, Jude applied this prophecy to the fake Christians who were causing trouble in their church.

This paragraph 17–19 provides a transition from Section 5–19 to Section 20–23.Jude began both paragraph 17–19 and the first paragraph of the next section (paragraph 20–21) by addressing his readers with exactly the same Greek words, literally, “But you, beloved.”

17a
But you, beloved, remember

- ¶ But, remember,^(plur) dear friends,
- ¶ But you,^(plur) my dear friends, you^(plur) must remember
- ¶ But as for you,^(plur) friends whom I love, I want you^(plur) to remember

But you, beloved, remember: Jude used this phrase to mark the text in 18b–d as being more important-Possible reasons why Jude marked this midrash (text-application) text as being more important include:(a)

because it was the last midrash text in his letter. (b) because it was the only text he cited from a Christian source. than the other textsThis refers to the text portions of the midrash text-application pairs in this Section 5–19. in the text-application pairs that preceded it in the letter. He indicated its importance in several ways:

- 1. He used an emphatic pronoun, you.
- 2. He addressed his readers directly with the expression, beloved.
- 3. He used an imperative verb. Jude told them to remember.

But: The Greek word *de* that the BSB translates here as *But* shows that this paragraph contrasts with the paragraphs that precede it.

beloved: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as *beloved* was also used in 3a and later at 20a. This was a normal way for Jude to address Christian friends whom he loved. See the note on 3a. See also *love*, Meaning 2, in the Glossary.

Languages differ in the most natural placement for a direct address. In some languages it may be most natural to begin the sentence with a direct address like this. In other languages, it is natural to put the direct address after the verb. In your translation, look for the position that is most natural for your language.

remember: Jude toldJude used an imperative verb form here, whereas he used a less directive form (aorist infinitive) in 5a. A literal translation of the Greek phrase that Jude wrote in 5a is “I want to remind you.” his readers to remember/recall a prophecy with which they were already familiar.

17b
what was foretold by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ

- what the apostles of our^(incl) Lord Jesus Christ said would happen.
- what the apostles of our^(incl) Lord Jesus told you^(plur) to expect.
- the prophecy made by the men whom our^(incl) Lord Jesus Christ appointed to speak for him.

what was foretold by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ: We do not know how Jude’s readers knew about this prophecy. They themselves may have heard the apostles speak it, or someone else may have reported it to them. The only other verse in the New Testament that this prophecy is mentioned is in the parallel passage in 2 Peter 3:3.

foretold: The Greek verb that the BSB translates as *foretold* is literally “spoken before.” It indicates here

that the apostles predicted what was going to happen. This can also be translated as:

- what the apostles...prophesied
- the predictions of the apostles (RSV)
- what the apostles...said would happen
- what the apostles...told you to expect (GW)

apostles: Jude probably referred here to men whom Jesus himself chose to be his apostles. This would include the twelve apostles whom Jesus chose while he was still on earth, and it might possibly include the apostle Paul. See *apostle* in the Glossary.

our Lord Jesus Christ: Jude used the phrase *our Lord Jesus Christ* to indicate the relationship that he and his readers had with their master, Jesus Christ. See *Lord* in the Glossary.

Jude 1:18
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18a

when they said to you,

- They told you,^(plur)

when they said to you: In some languages it may be more natural to omit this phrase or to combine it with 17b. For example:

...^{17b–18a} what the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ told you to expect: ^{18b} “In the last times...” (GW)

The phrase they said to you introduced the direct quotation of the prophecy (18b–d). This prophecy can also be translated as an indirect quotation. The general comment at the end of the notes for 18d illustrates this.

18b

“In the last times

- “In the last days,
- “During the final age,
- “Before the/our^(incl) Lord Jesus returns,

In the last times: In the New Testament, In the last times and similar expressions. For example, “in the last days.” (2 Timothy 3:1, 2 Peter 3:3), “in later times” (1 Timothy 4:1). refer to the time between Jesus’ resurrection and his return. Other ways to translate this include:

In the final age (REB)

near the end of time (CEV)

In the time before Jesus returns

18c

there will be scoffers

- there will be people who will mock/ridicule the Lord.
- people will mock/ridicule the Lord and his people.
- certain people will make fun of him and his people.

scoffers: The Greek word that the BSB translates as scoffers refers here to people who mock, ridicule, or make fun of someone else.

The prophecy Jude quoted here did not specify whom it was that the scoffers mocked. However, Jude applied this prophecy to the fake Christians, and they mocked the Lord and his people. The idea that the fake Christians mocked the Lord, or the Lord and his people, is consistent with what Jude said in the rest of this section. It also agrees with the parallel passage in 2 Peter 3:3–4. That passage speaks of people mocking Jesus and his promise to return, and by association, the true Christians who trusted in his promise to return. In some languages it may be necessary to specify whom they mocked. If that is true in your language, here are possible ways to translate this prophecy:

people who will mock/ridicule the Lord

people will make fun of the Lord and his people.

18d

who will follow after their own ungodly desires.”

- They will do the evil acts they desire to do.”
- They will use only their own sinful desires to decide what they will do.”
- Their own evil desires will lead them to sin against him.”

who will follow after their own ungodly desires:

This expression is similar to the one that Jude used in 16b (“follow their own desires”—GW). However, here

in 18d Jude added the word that the BSB translates as ungodly. See the note on 16b. If you did not use a word for ungodly in 16b, you will need to include that idea here.

ungodly: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as ungodly has already been used several times in this letter. This is the last time that Jude used it. It is recommended that you refer to the notes on 4c and 15b, 15c, and 15d. Translate in a way that will be appropriate to describe “desires.” It may be possible to use the same word that you used in 15c for the phrase “every ungodly act.”

General Comment on 18a–d

The phrase “they said to you” (18a) introduces a direct quotation of a prophecy (18b–d). It can also be translated as an indirect quotation. For example:

^{18a}They told you that ^{18b}near the end of time, ^{18c}selfish and godless people would start making fun of God. (CEV)

^{18a}that ^{18b}in the last times ^{18c}there would be scoffers ^{18d}whose purpose in life is to enjoy themselves in every evil way imaginable. (NLT)

Jude 1:19

Section 5–19: Jude gave illustrations to prove that the Lord would punish the fake Christians

In this section, Jude described the sins of the fake Christians in more detail. He also foretold that the Lord would punish them. He used a special Jewish styleAs mentioned in the Outline, this style was called “midrash.” Jewish rabbis sometimes used this text-application style of presentation. in these verses. He referred to different examples, often taken from the Bible. Then he applied these examples to the situation about which he was writing.

Jude organized this part of his letter as follows:

Example	Application
verses 5–7	verse 8Verse 8 is the application for the examples in 5–7 and could end that paragraph. Verse 8 also introduces 9–10 and could begin that paragraph. These Notes show the paragraph division between verse 7 and verse 8, as does almost every English version.
verse 9	verse 10

verse 11	verses 12–13
verses 14–15	verse 16
verses 17–18	verse 19

The main purpose of the section was to show that the Lord would certainly punish these fake Christians. Jude compared them with well-known individuals and groups mentioned in the Old Testament and in other Jewish writings. He also used things found in nature to describe their sinful ways. Through these examples, he explained that these fake Christians deserved the punishment which they would receive.

Paragraph 17–19

In this paragraph, Jude used the text-application styleThe style he used was the “midrash” style, which was sometimes used by Jewish rabbis (see the Introduction for these Notes). This midrash has a text-application pair. The text (18b–d) was a prophecy taught by the apostles of Jesus Christ. In verse 19, Jude applied this prophecy to the situation that Jude’s readers faced. again for the last time in his letter.This is the last midrash of the letter. (See Section 5–19 for more explanation of this style.) In verses 17–18 he reminded his readers of a prophecy which the apostles of Jesus Christ had made. They had prophesied that there would be scoffers who would follow their own evil desires. In verse 19, Jude applied this prophecy to the fake Christians who were causing trouble in their church.

This paragraph 17–19 provides a transition from Section 5–19 to Section 20–23.Jude began both paragraph 17–19 and the first paragraph of the next section (paragraph 20–21) by addressing his readers with exactly the same Greek words, literally, “But you, beloved.”

**19a
These are the ones who cause divisions,**

- These are the people who cause you^(plur) to divide into different groups.
- These are the same people who are causing you^(plur) not to be united.
- This prophecy told you^(plur) to expect these people, the very ones who are now creating factions among you^(plur).

These are: Jude referred again here to the fake Christians whom he mentioned frequently throughout his letterJude’s use of the word These to refer to the fake Christians is a characteristic of the central section of his letter (verses 5–19), the section containing every midrash he used. Jude 19 is the last verse of this section, and it is also the last time that Jude specifically used These as a way to introduce the application

part of a text-application pair in a midrash. (4, 8a, 10-13, 14b, 16a). Here he stated that they fulfilled the prophecy in 18b-d. You may need to make this connection clear in your translation. For example:

Now they are here, and they are the ones who...
(NLT)

And now these people are already making you
turn against each other. (CEV)

the ones who cause divisions: The true believers to whom Jude was writing were supposed to be united. The fake Christians, through their sinful behavior and false teaching, were causing these believers to divide into opposing groups/factions. Other ways to translate this include:

the people who are causing divisions among you

the ones who are causing you not to be united.

the people who are creating factions

19b who are worldly

- They behave according to their own natural instincts/desires,
- They do what they naturally desire to do.
- Their own natural instincts/desires control them.

who are worldly: The BSB clause, who are worldly, translates one word in Greek. This word may be translated literally as “natural.” In this context its meaning Jude used other phrases with a similar meaning. For example, “follow their own desires” (verse 16 in GW) and “who...follow after their own ungodly desires” (verse 18 in BSB). is similar to the expression “instinctively” in 10c. In that verse these fake Christians were described as being like unreasoning animals. They did what seemed right to them naturally, as determined by their own sinful natures.

These people were not motivated by love for the Lord or led by the Holy Spirit (19c). Instead, they were controlled by their own natural desires. Other ways to translate this include:

who are controlled by their natural desires (GNT)

whose thoughts are only of this world (NCV)

who follow mere natural instincts (NIV)

19c and devoid of the Spirit.

- and do not have the Holy Spirit.
- The Holy Spirit does not live in them.
- They do not have the Holy Spirit to guide them.

and devoid of the Spirit: The fake Christians only cared about their natural desires. They did not have the Spirit to show them a better way to think and live. In verse 19 Jude ended his description of the people against whom he wrote so strongly from verse 4 through verse 19. As he closed the portion of his letter dealing with these people, he left no doubt that they were not true Christians. Even though these people had infiltrated the church and mixed with the true believers, they did not really love God or desire to submit to him. They did not really believe in Jesus Christ or trust him to save them. They did not have the Holy Spirit. For this reason, these Notes have referred to them as fake Christians.

Here, the Spirit refers to the Holy Spirit. In some languages, it may be necessary to make this explicit. For example:

the Holy Spirit

God's Spirit

If you make this explicit, it is recommended that you use your key term for the Holy Spirit. This will match 20c, where Jude referred to the Spirit as “the Holy Spirit.”

Ways to translate 19c include:

they do not have the Holy Spirit.

the Holy Spirit does not live in them.

the Holy Spirit does not guide them.

Jude 1:20

Section 20-23: Jude encouraged believers to trust God and to help other people to trust him

In verses 20-21 Jude told his readers to keep experiencing God's love for them (21a), while waiting for Jesus to give them eternal life (21b-c). They were to do this by depending more and more on the truth that

Christians believe (20b), and by praying with the help of the Holy Spirit (20c).

In verses 22–23 Jude told his readers how they were to act toward three types of people. Jude instructed the Christians to: (a) show mercy to people who were uncertain about what to believe, (b) quickly rescue those who were beginning to follow the fake Christians, (c) while being very careful, show mercy to those who were already following these fake Christians. The fake Christians were harming these people through their false teaching and the sinful things that they did.

Paragraph 20–21

Jude wanted his readers to continue in fellowship with God, as they waited to experience the eternal life that Jesus had provided for them.

20–21

building yourselves up...praying...keep: The Greek verbs that the BSB translates as building...up (20b) and praying (20c) relate to keep in Jude 21a. Scholars have different views about exactly how these words relate to keep. Scholars have different opinions concerning the relationship of the participles in verse 20 to the main verb in verse 21, which the BSB translates as “keep.” Some scholars and versions interpret these participles as imperatives, because the main verb is imperative. Others interpret them as attendant circumstance, and still others as means. The Notes takes the view that they express the means by which Jude’s readers could keep themselves in God’s love. The NET says: The NET contains the following note for verse 20. “The participles in v. 20 have been variously interpreted. Some treat them imperatively or as attendant circumstance to the imperative in v. 21 (‘maintain’): ‘build yourselves up...pray.’ But they do not follow the normal contours of either the imperatival or attendant circumstance participles, rendering this unlikely. A better option is to treat them as the means by which the readers are to maintain themselves in the love of God. This both makes eminently good sense and fits the structural patterns of instrumental participles elsewhere.”

²⁰But you, dear friends, by building yourselves up in your most holy faith, by praying in the Holy Spirit, ²¹maintain yourselves in the love of God.... (NET)

In some languages, it may be necessary to reorder parts of verses 20 and 21 in order to express means. For example, it may be more natural for the verb keep to come before these two verbs. A general comment on 20–21 at the end of the notes for 21b–c gives examples.

20a

But you, beloved,

- ¶ But you,^(plur) my dear friends,
- ¶ But as for you,^(plur) friends whom I love,
- ¶ My friends, you^(plur) are different from them.

But you, beloved: The Greek words that the BSB translates here as But you, beloved are the same words that begin 17a.

These words begin a new section. They indicate that what Jude said in verses 20–21 was especially important.

But you: The Greek word *de* that the BSB translates here as But shows that this paragraph contrasts with the paragraph that precedes it.

The pronoun you is emphatic and implies a contrast between the fake Christians and Jude’s readers.

beloved: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as beloved was a normal way for Jude to address Christian friends whom he loved. It is used in the same way in 3a and 17a. See the note on 17a. See also love, Meaning 2, in the Glossary.

20b

by building yourselves up in your most holy faith

- by continually building yourselves^(plur) up on the very holy truths that you^(plur) believe,
- by continuing to build your^(plur) lives on the foundation of the completely holy truths that you^(plur) have learned and believe,
- You^(plur) have believed the completely true teaching that God gave us^(incl). By basing your^(plur) lives on it,

by building yourselves up in your most holy faith:

The Greek word that the BSB translates here as building...up is literally “building...upon.” This idiom may have well have been focusing on the foundation that was built upon, rather than on the exact nature of the building that was built upon it. Some versions make the building metaphor more explicit, by adding “foundation.” Their faith was something to build upon, like a foundation. This corresponds well with the case of the noun, *pistei*, which is dative. The word can be used in a literal way to refer to constructing a building on a foundation. In this verse it is used in a figurative way. It implies that the Christians should use their holy faith as the foundation or basis for their lives (for their thoughts and actions).

In some languages a literal translation of the figure of speech may not be clear. Other ways to express the idea are:

by building your lives on the foundation of your holy faith.

use your most holy faith to grow. (GW)

by depending on your most holy faith as the basis for your lives.

building yourselves up: This was a metaphor. It was based on constructing a building. In the New Testament, this metaphor was commonly used. However, it had been used so much by Jude's time that the saying probably had a set meaning. It had become a "dead metaphor." In that case, people may have no longer thought of constructing an actual building. In many languages it may be best to express the meaning here without the metaphor of building. For example:

By using your most holy faith to grow...

By trusting even more the most holy truths that you believe...

building...up: The form of the Greek verb that the BSB translates here as building...up indicates that the action should be continuing. The same is true for the other participles and verbs in this paragraph. It was something that Jude wanted his readers to keep doing; it was not an action that they would do only once. Some ways to indicate this in English are:

continue to build... (NLT)

keep building... (CEV)

In some languages, as in Greek, there is a verb form that indicates that an action is continuing. Look for the most natural way in your language to express this idea.

As stated in the note on 20–21, in this context building...up expresses a means or way by which Jude's readers could keep themselves in God's love (21a).

yourselves: Scholars interpret yourselves in different ways in this context:

1. Jude meant that each individual Christian should build himself or herself up.
2. Jude meant that the Christians were to build each other up.

If your language requires you to distinguish between these two interpretations, it is recommended that you follow interpretation (1). While interpretation (1) may have been Jude's primary meaning here, he certainly would have favored building others up as well.

in your most holy faith: In some languages, it may be more natural to translate this idea without using a preposition like in or "on." For example:

by continuing to use your most holy faith to build your lives

by basing your life/actions/thought more and more on the true teachings that you believe

your...faith: Here, your...faith refers to the true Christian teachings that Jude's readers had been taught. See faith, Meaning 2, in the Glossary. The Greek form that the BSB translates as your is plural. As Christians, this faith was something that they all believed.

most holy faith: Jude described their faith as most holy, because:

1. God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit. is holy, and God had revealed this faith to them.
2. This faith was about how God saved us by providing a holy sacrifice for our sins, Jesus Christ.
3. Nothing is more holy than God.

Jude was not comparing their faith to other faiths here. He was expressing the unique holiness of their faith. Other ways to translate most holy faith are:

most sacred faith (REB)

the truth about God that you believe

the unique beliefs that you received from God

20c and praying in the Holy Spirit,

- and by praying with the Holy Spirit helping/directing you,^(plur)
- and by continuing to pray with the Holy Spirit as your^(plur) guide,

and praying in the Holy Spirit: The note on 20–21 mentioned that the verb praying is related to the verb "keep" in 21a. Praying in the Holy Spirit was a means/way by which Jude's readers were to keep themselves in God's love (21a).

Praying in the Holy Spirit implies that they should be praying with the help and guidance of the Holy Spirit. Two ways to translate this are:

pray with the Holy Spirit helping/directing you.

praying with the Holy Spirit as your guide.

praying: The form of the Greek verb that the BSB translates here as praying indicates that the action should be continuing. The same is true for the other participles and verbs in this paragraph. Jude meant for his readers to continue to pray. Refer to the note on “building...up” in 20b. For example:

by continuing to pray as you are directed by the Holy Spirit.

Jude 1:21

Section 20–23: Jude encouraged believers to trust God and to help other people to trust him

In verses 20–21 Jude told his readers to keep experiencing God’s love for them (21a), while waiting for Jesus to give them eternal life (21b–c). They were to do this by depending more and more on the truth that Christians believe (20b), and by praying with the help of the Holy Spirit (20c).

In verses 22–23 Jude told his readers how they were to act toward three types of people. Jude instructed the Christians to: (a) show mercy to people who were uncertain about what to believe, (b) quickly rescue those who were beginning to follow the fake Christians, (c) while being very careful, show mercy to those who were already following these fake Christians. The fake Christians were harming these people through their false teaching and the sinful things that they did.

Paragraph 20–21

Jude wanted his readers to continue in fellowship with God, as they waited to experience the eternal life that Jesus had provided for them.

21

In this verse, Jude told his readers to maintain/keep themselves in God’s love, using the means that he described in verse 20. They were to continue to do this as they waited for the Lord, Jesus Christ, to return so that they could live forever with him.

21a

keep yourselves in the love of God

- maintain yourselves^(plur) in God’s love for you^(plur),
- keep experiencing God’s love for you^(plur),

- stay constantly aware that God loves you^(plur),

keep yourselves in the love of God: This clause means “continue to experience God’s love.” It indicates that Jude’s readers should always remember that God loves them. They should live in such a way that they enjoy that knowledge. They should not do anything that would hinder them from experiencing his love or from receiving his blessings. Some ways to translate this are:

maintain yourselves in God’s love.

keep experiencing God’s love for you.

always remain in God’s love for you.

keep: Jude frequently used the Greek verb *tēreō*, which the BSB translates as keep. He used a form of *tēreō* in 1f, 6a, 6c, 13d (where the BSB translates it as “reserved”), and here in 21a. It was possible for Jude to use one verb in all these contexts in Greek because *tēreō* could be used in many different ways.

In other languages, including English, it may not be natural or possible to use the same verb in all these contexts. In each context, you should use a verb that expresses the meaning in a natural way.

the love of God: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates as love of God in this context probably refers to God’s love for them, rather than to their love for God. Some English versions indicate this explicitly, including CEV, GW, JBP, NCV, NIV, NJB, and NLT. English versions which are ambiguous are: BSB, KJV, NASB, NET, NRSV, REB, RSV, and GNT. See love, Meaning 1, in the Glossary. Here is another way to translate this verse part:

Live in such a way that God’s love can bless you.
(NLT)

The phrase love of God is then parallel in meaning to “the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ” in 21c. These two phrases together are similar in meaning to what Jude wrote in 1e and 1f:

loved by God the Father and kept by Jesus Christ:

21b

as you await

- as you^(plur) wait
- as you^(plur) wait/hope for

- as you^(plur) keep looking forward to

21c

the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to bring you eternal life.

- to be transformed in order to live forever, because of the mercy that our^(incl) Lord, Jesus Christ has shown us^(incl).
- the time/day when our^(incl) Lord, Jesus Christ will return, so that you^(plur) will live with him forever, because he had mercy on us^(incl).
- the return of our^(incl) Lord, Jesus Christ. Then you^(plur) will live together with him forever because he is merciful/compassionate toward us.^(incl)

21b–c

as you await the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to bring you eternal life: A literal translation of 21b–c is: “anticipating the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to eternal life.” It can be difficult in English to show how the ideas in 21b–c are related to each other, and English versions differ in the ways they translate them. It may be easier to understand the meaning if the ideas are expressed in a different order. For example:

^{21c}Our Lord Jesus Christ is merciful to you. Because of his mercy, he will give you eternal life. ^{21b}You are expecting/waiting-for him to do that.

Below are some ways that English versions have expressed the meaning. Notice that in each version a different idea follows the verb. These ideas are underlined.

as you wait for our Lord Jesus Christ in his mercy to give you eternal life. (GNT)

as you wait for the eternal life that our Lord Jesus Christ in his mercy is going to give you. (NLT)

as you look forward to the day when our Lord Jesus Christ in his mercy will give you eternal life.

These are not different interpretations. Instead, they are different ways to express the same interpretation in a clear and natural way. Use a natural way to express the idea in your language. For example, in English, the objects “Jesus Christ” and “the day” are most natural when a form of the verb “wait” is used. The objects “eternal life” and “the day” work well in English with “look forward to.” However, while “the mercy” follows the form of the Greek wording, it is less natural with these verbs in English.

as you await: The Greek word that the BSB translates as you await is related to the verb “keep” in Jude 21a. Scholars have different views about exactly how it relates to this verb:

1. It relates to the time of the verb “keep.” The action of the verb (await) happens at the same time as the action “keep.” For example:

keep...as you wait (GNT)

maintain...while anticipating (NET)

Remain...as you look for (GW) (BSB, CEV, GW, KJV, NASB, NCV, NET, NIV, NLT, GNT)

1. It is another command, like the verb “keep.” The waiting was another thing that Jude told his readers to do. For example:

keep...and wait for (NJB)

Keep...and look forward to (REB) (JBP, NJB, NRSV, REB, RSV)

It is recommended that you follow interpretation (1), as the majority of the English versions do.

A general comment on 21b–c at the end of these notes for 21b–c gives suggestions for how to relate the parts of 21b–c to each other in a translation.

await: In the Bible, waiting and anticipation are often associated with the end times, and that is true here. Jude already referred to the end times in verses 6e and 14c–15. In this context, the Greek verb that the BSB translates as await means “expect” or “anticipate.” The English expression await is also used here with that meaning.

the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ: The mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ is the kindness that Jesus would show toward Jude’s readers. He would show this mercy to them specifically by giving them eternal life when he returned.

mercy: The Greek word that the BSB translates as mercy is also discussed in a note for verse 2. See mercy, Meaning 2, in the Glossary.

our Lord Jesus Christ: Jude used the phrase our Lord Jesus Christ to indicate the relationship that he and his readers had with their master Jesus Christ. This same phrase is also used in 4f and 17b. See Lord in the Glossary.

to bring you eternal life: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates here as to bring you eternal life is literally, “to/for eternal life.” The English versions have supplied a verb. For example, the BSB supplied to bring. Many English versions supply the verb “give.” (CEV, GW, NCV, NJB, NLT, REB, GNT). When considering whether a verb such as “give” should be supplied as implied information, you may wish to make sure that it does not imply that believers do not, in any way, have eternal life during their time on earth, because in one sense they do (John 3:36, John 5:24, and John 6:47). because it is required in English for the translation to be natural and clear.

eternal life: Here, eternal life is life that never ends. Jesus made eternal life possible by paying the penalty for people’s sins when he suffered and died on the cross. In one sense, Christians receive eternal life when they first believe in Jesus Christ as their Savior. However, in another sense, they will experience it fully only when Jesus returns. Then they will be transformed, and there will no longer be any sin or death.

Here Jude was talking about this time when Jesus returns. Here eternal life refers specifically to the life without end that believers experience following the resurrection of the dead that will take place when Jesus returns. It is not recommended that you include such details in your translation.

General Comment on 21b–c

A translator must determine the best way to write about the connection that Jude intended to express between his readers “awaiting,” “Jesus Christ,” “mercy,” and “eternal life.” The ways that English versions have expressed this may not fit your language. Here are some examples of other ways to express the relationship between the parts of 21b–c:

as you wait to be transformed in order to live forever, because our Lord Jesus Christ had mercy on us^(incl).

as you look forward to the return of our Lord Jesus Christ. Then you will enjoy the life that does not end, because he is compassionate toward us^(incl).

General Comment on 20–21

In English, this paragraph sounds more natural if its parts are reordered so that the main verb (BSB: “keep”) comes before the verbs of verse 20 (BSB: “building... up” and “praying”). Here are examples of how this might be done:

^{20a} But you, my dear friends, ^{21a} you should maintain yourselves in God’s love. ^{20b} Do this by building your lives upon the foundation of the uniquely holy truths that you believe, ^{20c} and by praying with the Holy Spirit as your guide, ^{21b} as you wait ^{21c} to live forever because of the mercy our Lord Jesus Christ shows us.

^{20a} My friends, ^{21a} continue to experience God’s love for you. ^{20b} Do this by basing your lives more and more on the most sacred truths you have believed ^{20c} and by praying with the guidance of the Holy Spirit. ^{21b} Keep doing this while you wait ^{21c} for the day when our Lord, Jesus Christ, will return. Then you will live forever, because he had mercy on us.

Jude 1:22

Section 20–23: Jude encouraged believers to trust God and to help other people to trust him

In verses 20–21 Jude told his readers to keep experiencing God’s love for them (21a), while waiting for Jesus to give them eternal life (21b–c). They were to do this by depending more and more on the truth that Christians believe (20b), and by praying with the help of the Holy Spirit (20c).

In verses 22–23 Jude told his readers how they were to act toward three types of people. Jude instructed the Christians to: (a) show mercy to people who were uncertain about what to believe, (b) quickly rescue those who were beginning to follow the fake Christians, (c) while being very careful, show mercy to those who were already following these fake Christians. The fake Christians were harming these people through their false teaching and the sinful things that they did.

Paragraph 22–23

In this paragraph, Jude told his readers to help three groups of people. In order to translate 22–23, a translator needs to decide how many different types of people Jude told his readers to help here. The English versions translate as follows: (1) Jude meant three types of people (BSB, GW, NASB, NCV, NET, NIV, NJB, NLT, NRSV, REB, RSV, GNT). (2) Jude meant two types of people (JBP, KJV). (3) The number is not clearly defined (CEV). It is recommended that you translate according to interpretation (1), that Jude here wrote about three distinct types of people influenced by the fake Christians. whom the fake Christians had influenced by their false teaching and sinful living.

The order in which Jude mentioned these three types of people relates to the amount of influence the fake

Christians had on each type. Their false teaching and sinful living had influenced the first type less than the second type, and the second type less than the third type.

22

And indeed, have mercy on those who doubt;

- ¶ Show^(plur) mercy to those people who do not know what to believe.
- ¶ You^(plur) should be kind and help those people who have doubts.
- ¶ Some people are wavering/unsteady about what they believe. Be^(plur) compassionate to them.

have mercy: The Greek verb that the BSB translates as have mercy means “to be kind and compassionate.” Jude wanted his readers to have mercy by helping these people.

Jude used the noun form of this word in verses 2 and 21b–c. See mercy, Meaning 3, in the Glossary.

on those who doubt: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates here as those who doubt refers to people in the church who were confused about what to believe. The church leaders taught God’s true message, but the fake Christians spoke and acted contrary to this true teaching.

Ways to translate this include:

those people who do not know what to believe

those people whose faith is wavering

those people who have doubts

Jude 1:23

Section 20–23: Jude encouraged believers to trust God and to help other people to trust him

In verses 20–21 Jude told his readers to keep experiencing God’s love for them (21a), while waiting for Jesus to give them eternal life (21b–c). They were to do this by depending more and more on the truth that Christians believe (20b), and by praying with the help of the Holy Spirit (20c).

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Christians were harming these people through their false teaching and the sinful things that they did.

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The order in which Jude mentioned these three types of people relates to the amount of influence the fake Christians had on each type. Their false teaching and sinful living had influenced the first type less than the second type, and the second type less than the third type.

23a

save others by snatching them from the fire;

- Quickly save/rescue^(plur) other people by snatching them from the eternal fire.
- Some other people whom you^(plur) know are headed for hell. Save/rescue^(plur) them by quickly pulling them from the eternal fire.
- As you^(plur) would quickly pull a stick from the fire to keep it from burning, save^(plur) some other people so that they will not be sent to hell.

save others by snatching them from the fire: In 23a, save others is the main idea. The phrase by snatching them from the fire expresses the way by which Jude’s readers should save these other people. English versions that translate this way include: BSB, GW, NET, NJB, NLT, NRSV, REB, RSV, GNT. Others may also be understood this way, especially the CEV and NASB.

See save, Word 1, in the Glossary.

others: The others here refers to the second type of people whom the fake Christians had influenced. Jude wanted his readers to help them, too. Because the fake Christians had more influence on this second group of people than on the first group in verse 22, they were in even greater spiritual danger. They seem to have believed the lies that the fake Christians had told them.

snatching them from the fire: Amos 4:11 and Zechariah 3:2 use similar figures of speech. These two

passages use the image of a stick being snatched from the fire to describe how the Lord rescued people from danger. The Greek word that the BSB translates here as snatching means to pull or remove something quickly. The phrase snatching...from the fire refers to pulling people away from the fire. Jude's readers were not literally snatching or pulling people from the fire of God's judgment. However, they could help people to repent and escape it. The Greek text has expressed this idea in a vivid way. Use an appropriate expression in your language to communicate this meaning.

from the fire: Scholars have different opinions about what the fire represents in this verse. Two different interpretations are:

1. The phrase the fire here is the eternal fire, also mentioned in verse 7. It refers to hell (or God's judgment of sinners). For example:

the fire of hell (GW)

the flames of judgment (NLT)

1. The phrase the fire here is a metaphor that represents some other unspecified danger. For example, the fire could represent their lifestyle of following the fake Christians.

It is most likely that the fire refers to hell or God's judgment, as interpretation (1) indicates. However, most English versions, including the BSB, do not make that idea explicit. If you must include this information, see the examples above and the Display for suggestions.

23b

and to still others show mercy tempered with fear,

- Show^(plur) mercy to still/yet others. However, be careful to avoid committing the same sins.
- You should be kind/compassionate to still other people, but help them cautiously,

and to still others: Here others refers to the third type of people whom the fake Christians had influenced. Their influence on this third type was even worse than it was on the first two types (verse 22–23a). The people of this third group believed the wrong teaching of the fake Christians and committed the same sins.

show mercy: The Greek verb that the BSB translates here as show mercy is the same word that the BSB translates as “have mercy” in verse 22. (See the note on verse 22.) It means to be kind and compassionate to people by helping them. Jude wanted his readers to do this for the people mentioned in verse 22, and

also for this third group of people (23b–c). See mercy, Meaning 3, in the Glossary.

tempered with fear: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates here as tempered with fear is literally with fear. Scholars have different opinions about who or what it was that Jude wanted his readers to fear:

1. Jude was telling his readers to fear becoming involved in the same sins as these people. For example:

^{23b}There are still others to whom you need to show mercy, but be careful ^{23c}that you aren't contaminated by their sins. (NLT) (CEV, GW, NJB, NLT)

1. Jude was telling his readers to fear God, to revere and respect him. For example:

have mercy on others, coupled with a fear of God. (NET) (NET)

Most English versions are ambiguous. It is recommended that you follow interpretation (1). It fits the context better, and it has more support in commentaries. Although Jude wanted his readers to help these people, he cautioned them to be careful, lest contact with them lead his readers to sin.

23c

hating even the clothing stained by the flesh.

- Detest even the clothes they have stained/soiled by their filthy/sinful deeds.
- so that you are not tempted by their sins, and become stained by committing those sins yourselves.

hating even the clothing stained by the flesh: Jude further explained here what he meant by “with fear” in 23b by using a figure of speech. He mentioned that people stained their clothes as a result of sin. They could do this by an emission from their bodies. For example, someone who drank too much alcohol might soil his clothes with vomit or urine, or people might soil their clothes through sinful sexual acts.

Jude used the stained clothes as a figure of speech to emphasize that his readers must be very careful to avoid those sins. The people's soiled clothing represented their sinful actions. Jude was not afraid that his readers might literally touch the soiled clothing. He did not want them to have anything to do with those sins in any way.

In some languages this figure of speech may not express the right meaning. If that is true in your language, it may be best to use a more general

expression. For example, some English versions do not mention clothes:

...afraid that you might be stained by their sinful lives. (GW)

but be careful that you aren't contaminated by their sins. (NLT)

hating: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as hating may be translated in this context as:

avoiding

detesting

In some languages it may not be natural to use a verb like “hate” for an object like clothes. Look for a verb in your language that fits this context.

even: The BSB and most other English versions translate the Greek word *kai* here as *even*. BGD classifies this use of *kai* as *ascensive* (II.2). The clause it introduces (“hating even the clothing stained by corrupted flesh”) intensifies what precedes it (“be merciful with fear”). Jude was highlighting the caution his readers were to exercise in their dealings with this third group of people whom they were to help. He intensified the extent to which they were to be cautious by mentioning that they were to hate/detest even the things associated with the sins of these people. The things he chose were the clothes that these people stained through their sinful actions. To highlight and intensify the degree to which they were to avoid moral corruption, he speaks of detesting, and hence being careful around, even things that could cause physical contamination or corruption. What makes this verse part particularly difficult to translate is that a translation, even with implied information made explicit, will usually sound as if Jude was really warning his readers to avoid physical contact with stained clothing. That was not Jude's concern. Rather, by telling them to detest even the physical clothing, he intensified his real point, that they are to be extremely cautious lest they suffer moral contamination through becoming involved in the sins of the people they were to be helping. Jude used it to emphasize that his readers should be very careful not to sin. They must fear sinning so much that they would even avoid anything that represented the sins, like the sinners' soiled clothing.

the clothing: The word that the BSB translates here as clothing refers to an inner garment worn next to

the skin. The NRSV calls this garment “the tunic.” not to the long outer garment that people wore at that time. If you refer to clothing in your translation, here are two options:

- Use a general expression like “clothes,” clothing, or “garments.”
- Use a specific word that refers to a type of clothing that people wear next to their skin. This is only a concern if your language and culture make a similar distinction between outer and inner garments. If a generic term, like clothing, sounds natural in this context, then you may use it.

Avoid words that refer to an outer garment, like a coat, that people often remove.

stained: You may need to translate this idea differently. Use a natural expression to refer to the idea in this context.

Other ways that English versions have translated the idea of stained are:

made dirty (CEV)

polluted (NASB)

contaminated (NLT, REB)

defiled (NRSV)

the flesh: The word that the BSB translates as flesh refers literally to “the body.” However, Jude used the flesh here as a metaphor to refer to the sinful desires and actions. A good case can be made that “the flesh” refers to the body itself that craves for things. An even better case can be made that “the flesh” refers to the sinful nature of these people that led them to sin. Ultimately, however, “the flesh” points to the sins themselves. The sinful nature of these people committed these sins in order to satisfy sinful cravings of the body. The three concepts are so integrally connected, that it is hard to conceive of one without the other two. of the people. This refers to the third type/group of people that Jude wanted his readers, the Christians, to help. See flesh in the Glossary.

The flesh was a good way for Jude to speak about the people's sins, because they often sinned to indulge the lusts/desires of their bodies. Examples of these sins are:

General Comment on 22–23

1. eating too much food,

2. drinking too much alcohol,
3. having sex outside of marriage.

In verses 22–23 Jude mentioned three types of people. His readers knew some people of all three types, because such people were members of their church. In some languages, it may be helpful to imply this in some way. For example:

other people you know

other people in your church/congregation

Jude 1:24

Section 24–25: Jude praised God

Jude ended his letter by praising God. The Apostle Paul ended his letter to the Romans in a similar way (Romans 16:25–27). First, Jude assured his readers that God was able to protect them from falling away from their faith into a life of sin (24a). Despite the danger from the false teaching and sinful living of the fake Christians, Jude declared that God was able to keep them from sinning in that way, so that after they died, they would be with God. With God they would experience great joy and have no sin (24b). Jude praised God for who he is. He is the only God. and for what he has done. He has saved us through our Lord, Jesus Christ. (25a–b). He listed some attributes of God: glory, majesty, power, and authority. Jude ascribed these attributes to God for all times: past, present, and in the future.

24–25

Now to Him...to the only God our Savior be glory...

Amen: In these verses Jude praised God using a special form called a “doxology.” The words to Him and to the only God our Savior are part of this special form of praise. In the Bible, authors often concluded a book, letter, or section of a letter with a doxology. If possible, you should be consistent in the way you translate doxologies throughout the Bible.

24

In this verse, Jude spoke of God as the one who could protect his readers from sin and cause them to be with him forever.

24a

Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling

- ¶ God is able to protect/defend you^(plur) so that you^(plur) do not fall,
- ¶ In conclusion, God is the one who is able to protect/defend you^(plur) so that sin/evil will not trip you.^(plur)

- ¶ Glory belongs to God. He is able to keep you^(plur) from falling away from him.

Now to Him who is able: The Greek expression that the BSB translates as to Him who is able describes God. It is literally “to the being-able-(one).” It is linked closely to the phrase “to the only God” in verse 25. *Tō*, the masculine definite article is in the dative case, as is *monō theō*, “only God,” at the beginning of verse 25. God is the only one who can do the things that this verse mentions. Jude’s readers could not do those things to save themselves.

In some languages it may be more natural to use the word for “God” here in 24a. For example:

God can guard you so that you don’t fall. (GW)

God is strong and can help you not to fall. (NCV)

to keep you: The Greek verb that the BSB translates here as keep is different from the verb that Jude used. In this letter, the BSB translates this Greek verb in different ways: “kept” (1f, 6c), “stay” (6a) “keep” (21a), and “reserved” (13d). in 1f, 6a, 6c, 13d See the first footnote under the note for “reserved.”, and 21a. In this context, it means:

guard

defend

protect

Jude indicated that God was able to protect his readers from the bad influence of the fake Christians. In English the words “keep from” have the same meaning. Look for the most natural way in your language to make the meaning clear.

you: Although you refers to Jude’s readers, what Jude said in this verse is true for everyone who trusts in God and in Jesus Christ.

from stumbling: The Greek word that the BSB translates as from stumbling is literally “without stumbling.” In this context it is used as a figure of speech. It may refer to stumbling from faith into a life of sin. Specifically, it may imply being deceived by the sinful living and false teaching of the fake Christians. God was able to protect Jude’s readers from this type of stumbling and falling. Many scholars understand stumbling to refer to not attaining salvation at the final judgment.

In some languages it may be necessary to make the meaning more explicit. For example:

God is able to protect/defend you so that sin/evil will not trip you.

God is the one who can protect you from falling away from him into a sinful life.

24b

and to present you unblemished in His glorious presence, with great joy—

- and he is also able to cause you^(plur) to stand before himself, the glorious God, and to be without guilt and extremely happy there.
- He is able to bring you^(plur) to himself where his splendor shines, and to make you^(plur) innocent and full of joy when you^(plur) stand there.
- He is also able to remove all your^(plur) faults and to cause you^(plur) to come into his presence and see his brightness. When this happens you^(plur) will be extremely happy.

to present you unblemished in His glorious presence: The Greek word that the BSB translates as to present is literally “to set/place/put.” It is God who would cause Jude’s readers to be in His glorious presence.

unblemished: God was able to protect Jude’s readers from falling away from him because of sin (24a), and also to remove from them all the guilt of their sins. Then it would be as if these Christians had never sinned at all. They would appear before God unblemished or without fault. There would be nothing for which God would blame them. A positive way to state this is:

so that you will be innocent....

in His glorious presence: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates here as His glorious presence is literally “the glory of him” or “his glory.” It refers here to being in the presence of God, that is, with God. The BSB supplies the word presence. It is natural in English to use the word presence when referring to someone very great, such as God, a king, or a person of high status. Another way to say this is:

with God himself in his glory

with him where you will see his glory

glorious: The Greek words that the BSB translates here as glorious are literally “the glory.” In this context this expression refers to the excellence of God’s divine qualities. Everything about God is the best. God is so splendid and great that nothing can even be compared to him. Sometimes the visible sign of his splendor is described as very bright light. The Bible indicates that bright light is part of God’s splendor. (See, for example, Exodus 24:17 and Revelation 21:23.) See glory, Meaning 2, in the Glossary. Another way to translate this is:

before him, where his splendor shines.

with great joy: Jude also wanted his readers to know that they would be very joyful when they came to God. Because they would be “unblemished” or without fault, they would not have to be afraid that God would punish them. Their joy would not be diminished by sin or fear. Other ways to translate this include:

extremely happy

full of joy (GW)

rejoicing (NET)

jubilant (REB)

General Comment on 24b

In some languages it may be more natural to reorder the phrases in 24b. For example:

He is also able to remove all your sins so that you will be innocent when he brings you into his glorious presence. This will be a time of great joy for you.

Jude 1:25

Section 24–25: Jude praised God

Jude ended his letter by praising God. The Apostle Paul ended his letter to the Romans in a similar way (Romans 16:25–27). First, Jude assured his readers that God was able to protect them from falling away from their faith into a life of sin (24a). Despite the danger from the false teaching and sinful living of the fake Christians, Jude declared that God was able to keep them from sinning in that way, so that after they died, they would be with God. With God they would experience great joy and have no sin (24b). Jude praised God for who he is. He is the only God. and for what

he has done. He has saved us through our Lord, Jesus Christ. (25a–b). He listed some attributes of God: glory, majesty, power, and authority. Jude ascribed these attributes to God for all times: past, present, and in the future.

25a

to the only God our Savior

- He is the only God and the one who saved us^(incl)
- He is the only true God. He has saved us^(incl)

to the only God our Savior: Here Jude affirmed that there is only one God, that he is the only true God, and that God is our Savior.

our Savior: It was common in the Old Testament to speak about God as Savior. God saves (rescues) his people from many types of danger or harm.

In the New Testament this word usually refers to the salvation which God provided through Jesus. This is the way that Jude used it in this verse. Through Jesus Christ, God saved people from being slaves to their sins and from eternal punishment and separation from God. Other ways to say this are:

our rescuer

our deliverer

Savior: The Greek word that the BSB translates as Savior has the same root as the one that was translated “salvation” in 3c. This is the same Greek word that the Bible often uses to talk about Jesus. See save, Word 3, in the Glossary.

25b

be glory, majesty, dominion, and authority

- Glory, majesty, power, and rule were his/God’s since
- Excellence/splendor, supreme greatness, perfect/complete power, and rightful rule belong to God.
- God is great and excellent. He has the power to do what he wants, and he has the right to rule.

be glory, majesty, dominion, and authority: The Greek text of Jude 25 has no verb. However, in English and some other languages, it is necessary to supply a verb. There are two ways to interpret the meaning of the Greek text here:

1. Jude was giving praise to God by stating what God is like. So, glory, majesty, dominion, and authority are attributes of God. In English, this idea can be expressed by a verb like “belong” or “are.” For example:

glory, majesty, power, and authority belong to him. (NLT)

1. Jude was expressing as a type of prayer or desire for God to receive glory, majesty, dominion, and authority. For example:

To him be glory, greatness, power, and authority. (NCV)

It is difficult to determine which interpretation English versions follow only by the verb that is used. It is recommended that you follow interpretation (1). Jude was praising God by describing what he is like.

glory: The Greek word that the BSB translates as glory is another form of the word that was translated as “glorious” in 24b. In both places it refers to God’s splendor and excellence. Everything about God is the best. He is so splendid and great that nothing can even be compared to him. Sometimes the glory of God is described as the bright light that is part of his splendor. glory, as it is used here, is not something external to God or something that he is given. Rather, it is a characteristic of God himself. Everything about him is the best. He has this glory as part of who and what he is. See glory, Meaning 1, in the Glossary.

majesty: This refers to God’s greatness as the king. There is no greater ruler. If your language has a word or phrase that describes the splendor or greatness of an earthly king or chief, you may be able to use it here.

dominion: The Greek word that the BSB translates here as dominion refers to the fact that God is able to do whatever he wants. God is able to accomplish all his perfect plans. In this context, the word does not refer to physical power or strength.

authority: The meaning of the Greek word that the BSB translates as authority is related to the word translated “dominion.” Here, authority refers to God’s right to rule as the absolute sovereign. He is the rightful ruler of everyone and everything.

25c

through Jesus Christ our Lord

- through our^(incl) Lord, Jesus Christ.
- by means of what our^(incl) Lord, Jesus Christ, has done for us.

through Jesus Christ our Lord: Scholars have different opinions concerning how this phrase relates to the other parts of this verse. Two possibilities are:

1. It connects with “our Savior” in 25a. Jesus Christ is the agent/person through whom God saved us.

God is our Savior through Jesus Christ our Lord. For example:

^{25a}to the only God, our Savior ^{25c}through Jesus Christ our Lord, (RSV)

1. It connects with the list of God's attributes in 25b, that is, "glory, majesty, dominion, and authority." For example:

^{25a}to the only God our Saviour, ^{25b}...glory and majesty, power and authority, ^{25c}through Jesus Christ our Lord, (REB)

Many English versions are ambiguous on this issue. It is impossible to determine which interpretation they follow, based only on the order of phrases. It is recommended that you follow interpretation (1), which fits best with the meaning of each part of the doxology.

Jesus Christ our Lord: This has the same meaning as the similar phrase "our Lord Jesus Christ." See the notes on 17b and 21b–c. See also Lord in the Glossary.

25d
before all time, and now, and for all eternity. Amen.

- before time began, are still his now, and will remain/be his forever. Amen.
- This has been true since before time began, it is still true now, and it will always be true. Amen.
- Since before time began he has been like this. He still is like this now, and he always will be like this. Indeed!

In the Greek text of Jude 25, this verse part follows 25b. The attributes of God listed there, "glory, majesty, dominion, and authority," belonged to God for all time. They were his "before all time," and they belong to him "now, and for all eternity."

before all time, and now, and for all eternity: The Greek expressions that the BSB translates as before all time, and now, and for all eternity refer to time. They work together to communicate one idea: The attributes in 25b always have belonged to God and always will.

In the notes below, definitions are given for each of these expressions of time. However, in many languages it is not necessary to translate each expression separately to communicate the idea. Look for the most natural way in your language to communicate the meaning. Your translation does not have to follow the form of the Greek text. Examples include:

from the start of time until today and until the end of time

from the very beginning to the very end

It has always been so, and it always will be so.

always and forever

before all time: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates here as before all time is literally "before all the time/eternity." This means before time even began. Some ways to say this include:

before all ages

before time began/was

before God created anything

now: This means more than just "today." It refers to the passing of time in this present age, including the time now.

for all eternity: The Greek phrase that the BSB translates here as for all eternity is literally "into all the ages," and it means "forevermore, never to end."

Amen: This word occurs over one hundred times in the New Testament, so you have probably seen it before. It may be familiar to your readers from the Bible version in your national language, or your people may use it to end prayers. If this is so, it is recommended that you use that familiar term here.

However, you may decide to use an expression from your own language to translate the meaning. Some ways to express the meaning in English are:

Truly!

Indeed!

So it shall be.

General Comment on 24–25

In some languages, it may be necessary or more natural to identify God as "the only God" at the beginning of this paragraph. In addition, it may be clearer if you reorder other parts of this paragraph. For example:

^{25a}The only God ^{24a}is the one who is able to keep you from falling, ^{24b}and he is able to make you innocent and joyful when he brings you to stand before him in his glory. ^{25a}He has saved us ^{25c}through our Lord, Jesus Christ. ^{25b}Glory, majesty, power, and authority were his ^{25d}since before time began, are still his now, and will be his forever. Amen.